

PRODUCT & ADMINISTRATOR DOCUMENTATION

Everything we have built for Vaaram Magazine.

A complete walkthrough of the website as it stands today — every public page, every admin screen, every field you will type into, what the free hosting tiers allow, and the short list of things still needed before launch.

92% complete

The website is built, tested and working end to end. What remains is hosting, the domain, the mailbox and a handful of account details only you can provide.

PREPARED FOR

Vaaram Magazine

PRODUCT

vaaram.ca — weekly edition website

DOCUMENT VERSION

1.0

DATE

10 September 2026

What is in this document

Read Part 3 if you only read one part — it is the operating manual for the admin dashboard, with a worked example of every job you will do each week.

Part 1 — The product

- 1.1 What Vaaram Magazine is, as a website
- 1.2 The weekly cycle, start to finish
- 1.3 How the site is put together (in plain English)
- 1.4 Where every file and record actually lives
- 1.5 What is finished, and what the 8% is

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- 2.3 Archives — grid, list, calendar and search
- 2.4 An edition page and the built-in reader
- 2.5 About
- 2.6 Contact, and what happens to an enquiry
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- 5.7 One page to send back to us

Appendices

- A Environment variables in full
- B The four database tables
- C Security measures already in place
- D Glossary

About the screenshots in this document

Every screenshot was taken from the real, finished website running with sample content — the same code that will go live. Because the site is not hosted yet, the demonstration used sample editions, sample advertisers and sample enquiries so that each screen could be shown full rather than empty. Wherever a screen will look different once the live database and storage accounts are connected, this document says so directly underneath.

01 The product

What has been built, what it does for a reader, what it does for an advertiser, and where every file and record actually lives.

- 1.1 What Vaaram Magazine is, as a website
- 1.2 The weekly cycle, start to finish
- 1.3 How the site is put together, in plain English
- 1.4 Where every file and record actually lives
- 1.5 What is finished, and what the 8% is

1.1 What Vaaram Magazine is, as a website

Vaaram Magazine is a weekly advertising and classifieds publication. Every Sunday one new edition is published as a single, complete PDF. The website exists to do four things, and it does all four today.

IT DOES THIS	WHICH MEANS, CONCRETELY
Publishes	You drag this week's print-ready PDF into the admin dashboard. The cover picture and page count are worked out automatically, the edition appears on the home page and in the archive within a minute, and it is given its own permanent web address.
Is read	Anyone can read the whole edition inside the website itself — no account, no payment, no app. They can zoom, turn pages, go full screen, or download the original PDF to keep.
Is kept	Every past edition stays online forever, browsable as a grid, a list or a calendar, and searchable. Nothing is ever taken down, which is what makes an advertisement worth buying.
Sells	Two separate income streams are supported: advertisements printed <i>inside</i> the weekly PDF (you lay those out yourself), and paid banner advertisements placed <i>on the website</i> in ten defined slots, each with its own view and click counter.

It is deliberately **not** a news site, not a directory, and not a marketplace with listings you have to maintain one by one. The magazine is the product; the website is its shop window, its archive and its order desk.

Who uses it, and what they each get

PERSON	WHAT THE SITE GIVES THEM
A reader	This week's edition on the home page, a reader that works on a phone, a download button, an archive of every past week, and a one-line sign-up to be emailed when the next edition lands.
A business thinking about advertising	An About page that explains exactly how an advertisement becomes an edition, the sizes sold (full page down to classified lines), answers to the six questions people ask before booking, and a contact form that reaches you in seconds.
An existing advertiser	Their advertisement inside the PDF, permanently archived and findable by search engines; optionally a banner on the website with honest view and click numbers you can quote back to them.
You, the publisher	One dashboard: publish an edition, manage banners, read every enquiry, own the reader list, and see how each edition is performing.

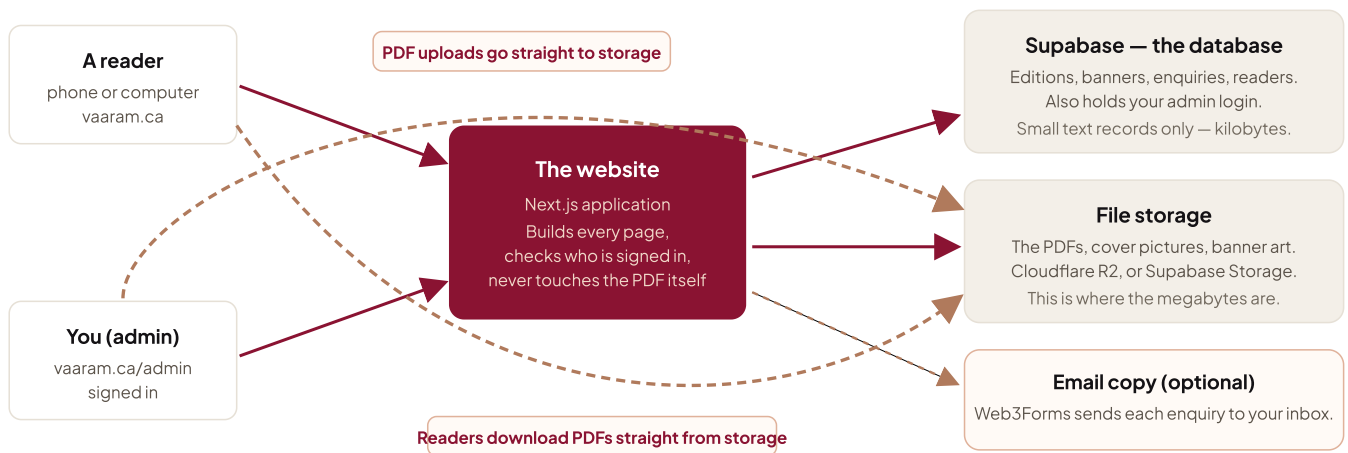
1.2 The weekly cycle, start to finish

This is the loop the whole system is built around. Steps 1 to 3 happen off the website; steps 4 to 7 are the website doing its job.



1.3 How the site is put together, in plain English

Four separate services do four separate jobs. This matters because each one has its own free allowance, and because it is why the site can serve a 30 MB magazine without a big hosting bill.



The one detail worth understanding

The PDF never passes through the website itself — not when you upload it, and not when a reader opens it. The website hands out a temporary, signed permission slip and the file travels directly between the browser and the storage bucket. That is why there is no upload size problem with a 40 MB print-ready edition, and it is also why the storage account you choose (Part 4) is the one that decides your bandwidth bill.

1.4 Where every file and record actually lives

THING	LIVES IN	NOTES
The weekly PDF	File storage <code>editions/</code>	Named automatically, e.g. <code>editions/2026-09-13-a4f2c19b-vaaram-issue-205.pdf</code> . Never renamed or overwritten.
Cover thumbnail	File storage <code>images/</code>	A JPEG made from page 1 of the PDF, in your own browser, at the moment you upload.
Banner artwork	File storage <code>images/</code>	Up to three files per banner — desktop, tablet, phone.
Edition details	Database — <code>publications</code>	Title, date, description, page count, file size, web address, published or draft, view and download counts.
Banners	Database — <code>ad_banners</code>	Advertiser, placement, link, expiry, impressions, clicks.
Enquiries	Database — <code>enquiries</code>	Every contact form message, with a status of new, contacted or closed.
Reader list	Database — <code>subscribers</code>	Email address, where it was collected, and whether it is still active.
Your admin login	Supabase Authentication	Not in any table you can see. Passwords are stored hashed by Supabase, not by us.
The wording of the site	In the code — <code>site.config.ts</code>	Name, tagline, phone, address, opening hours, ticker messages, categories and the FAQ. One file, one edit, changes everywhere.

1.5 What is finished, and what the 8% is

The build is done. Every screen in this document is real, working software that was exercised end to end while this document was written — a PDF was genuinely uploaded and published, a banner was genuinely created, a contact form was genuinely submitted and read in the dashboard. What is outstanding is **configuration and access**, not construction.

AREA	STATE	DETAIL
Public website — all nine pages	COMPLETE	Home, archive, edition reader, about, contact, privacy, terms, not-found, plus sitemap and social cards.
Admin dashboard — all seven screens	COMPLETE	Dashboard, issues, publish, edit, banners, enquiries, readers, settings.
Publishing an edition	COMPLETE	Tested with a real PDF: page count, cover thumbnail, upload, publish, appears on the home page.
Banner system — 10 placements	COMPLETE	Per-device artwork, expiry dates, impression and click counting.
Enquiries and reader list	COMPLETE	Both write to the database, both are readable and manageable in the dashboard.
Security — logins, permissions, headers	COMPLETE	See Appendix C.
Design, branding, dark mode, mobile	COMPLETE	Logo, typography and colour applied throughout; every page tested at phone width.
Live hosting	PART DONE	A Vercel project is already connected to the code and builds it successfully on every change — the site deploys cleanly today. What remains is the plan choice, the live credentials and the domain. See 5.2.
Domain pointed at the site	OUTSTANDING	Needs GoDaddy access — see 5.3.
contact@vaaram.ca mailbox	OUTSTANDING	The address is printed all over the site but no inbox exists that we can reach — see 5.4.
Database and storage accounts	OUTSTANDING	Free accounts, roughly one hour of setup — see 5.5.
Real phone number and address	OUTSTANDING	The site currently shows deliberately fake placeholders — see 5.6.
Sending the weekly newsletter email	BY DESIGN	The list is owned and exportable; the sending itself needs a mail provider — see 3.11.

Where the 92% comes from

Twelve of the thirteen lines above are finished software. The remaining work is a checklist of accounts, credentials and a domain — roughly one working day once the details in Part 5 are in hand.

02

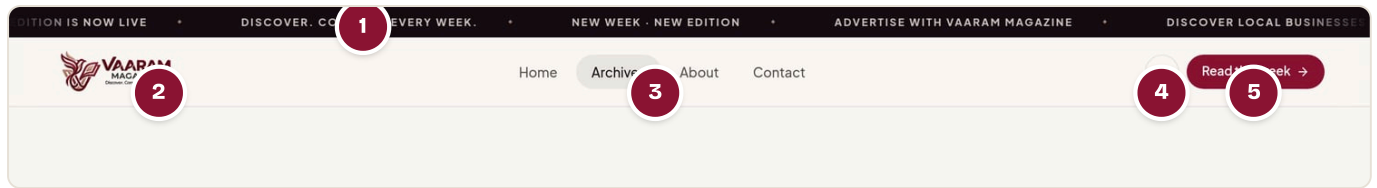
The public website, page by page

Nine pages exist. This part shows each one, says exactly what is on it, where the content comes from, and which parts you control from the admin dashboard.

2.1	The furniture on every page
2.2	Home
2.3	Archives — grid, list, calendar, search
2.4	An edition page and the reader
2.5	About
2.6	Contact, and what happens to an enquiry
2.7	Privacy, Terms, page not found
2.8	On a phone, and in dark mode
2.9	What Google and Facebook see

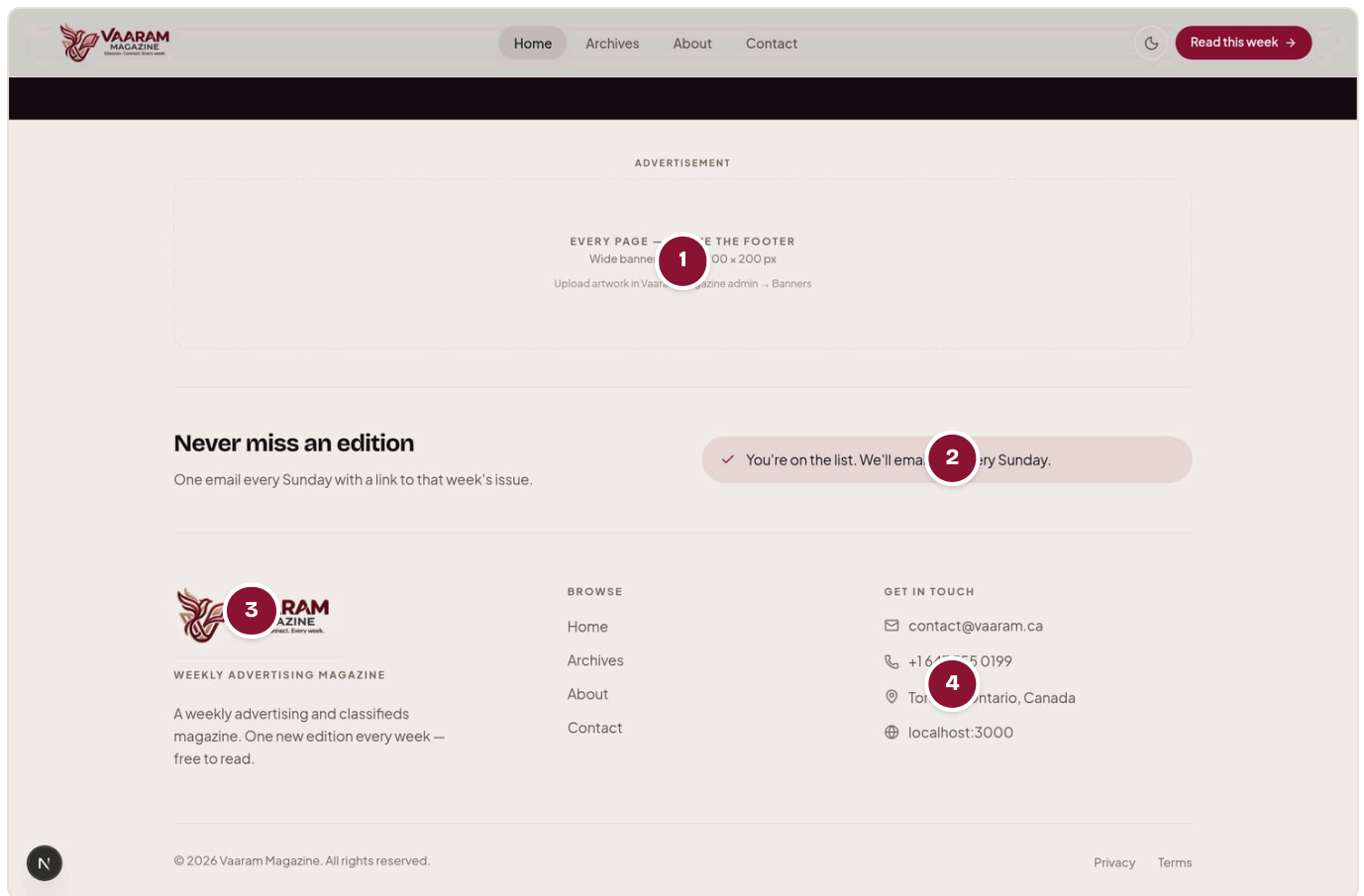
2.1 The furniture on every page

Three elements repeat on every single page of the site.



- 1 **The ticker.** A slow-scrolling strip of six publication messages — “This week’s edition is now live”, “Advertise with Vaaram Magazine”, and so on. These are advertising messages, never headlines; Vaaram is not a news outlet. They are edited in `site.config.ts`.
- 2 **The logotype.** Your official 3D embossed mark. It always returns to the home page.
- 3 **Four links only.** Home, Archives, About, Contact. The page you are on is highlighted.
- 4 **Light / dark switch.** The reader’s choice is remembered on their device.
- 5 **“Read this week”.** The one action the site wants from a visitor. It always jumps to the newest published edition.

Figure 2.1 — the header, shown on the Archives page.

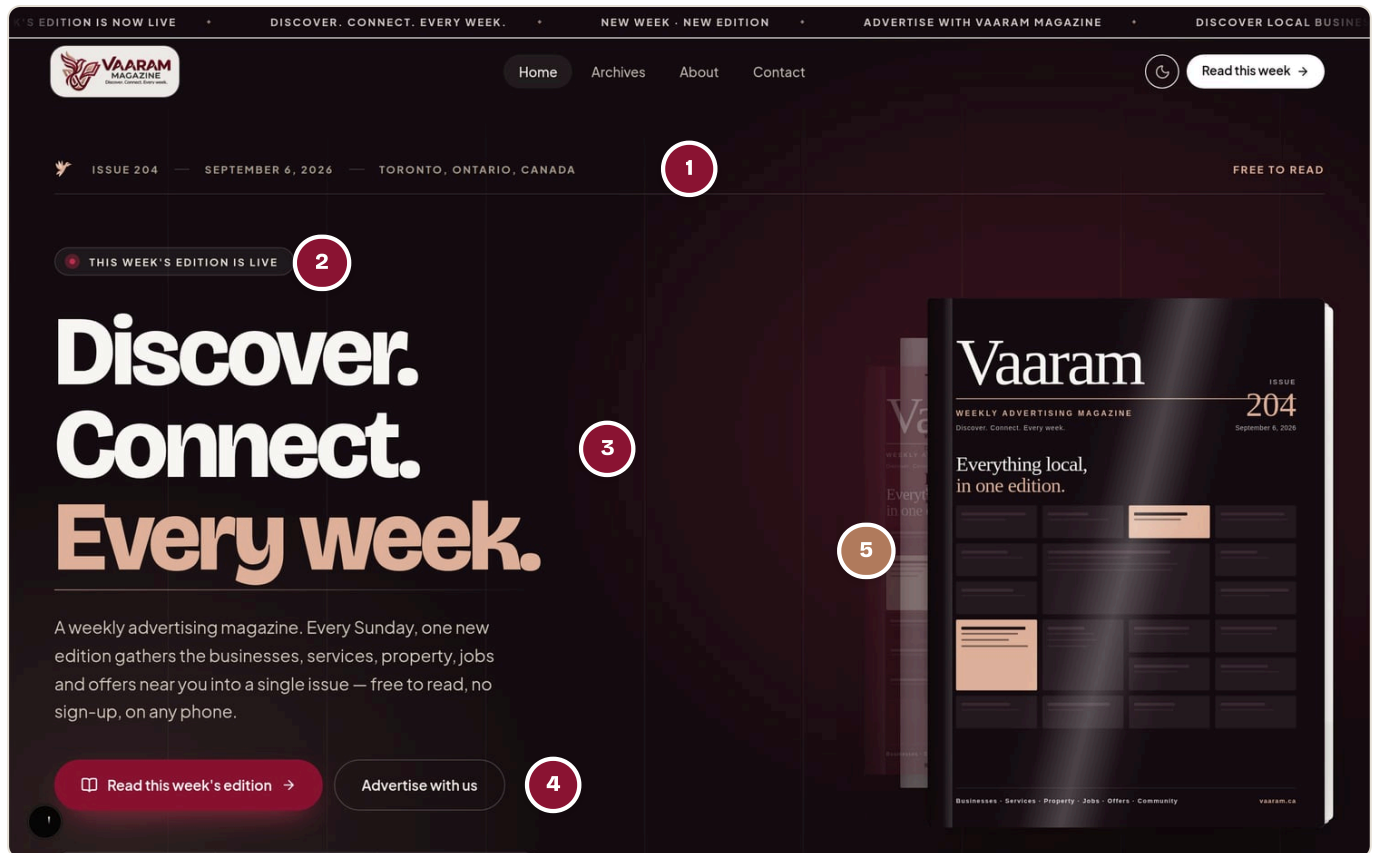


- 1 **The footer banner slot.** One paid placement that appears above the footer on *every* page of the site — the highest-volume slot you can sell. Shown here empty.
- 2 **“Never miss an edition”.** The sign-up box — one email address, nothing else. Shown here immediately after a real sign-up: “*You’re on the list. We’ll email you every Sunday.*” Every address collected here lands in Admin → Readers.
- 3 **Logotype and one-line description,** repeated for anyone who scrolled past the top.
- 4 **Your contact block** — email, phone, address and web address, all pulled from `site.config.ts`. The phone number shown is still a placeholder (see 5.6).

Figure 2.2 — the footer, identical on every page, captured the moment a reader joined the list.

2.2 Home

The home page has eleven bands. Its job is to get a first-time visitor into this week's edition, and a business owner into the contact form. Each band is shown below in order.



- 1 **Live edition line.** Issue number, publication date, city, and "Free to read". Taken automatically from the newest published edition — you never type it here.
- 2 **"This week's edition is live"** pill with a pulsing dot.
- 3 **The tagline as the headline.** Fixed brand wording.
- 4 **Two buttons:** "Read this week's edition" opens the reader; "Advertise with us" goes to Contact.
- 5 **The cover picture,** three-dimensional, with the two previous editions stacked behind it. This is the thumbnail generated from page 1 of your PDF.

Figure 2.3 — Home, band 1. Shown here with the sample edition; on the live site this is whatever you published most recently.

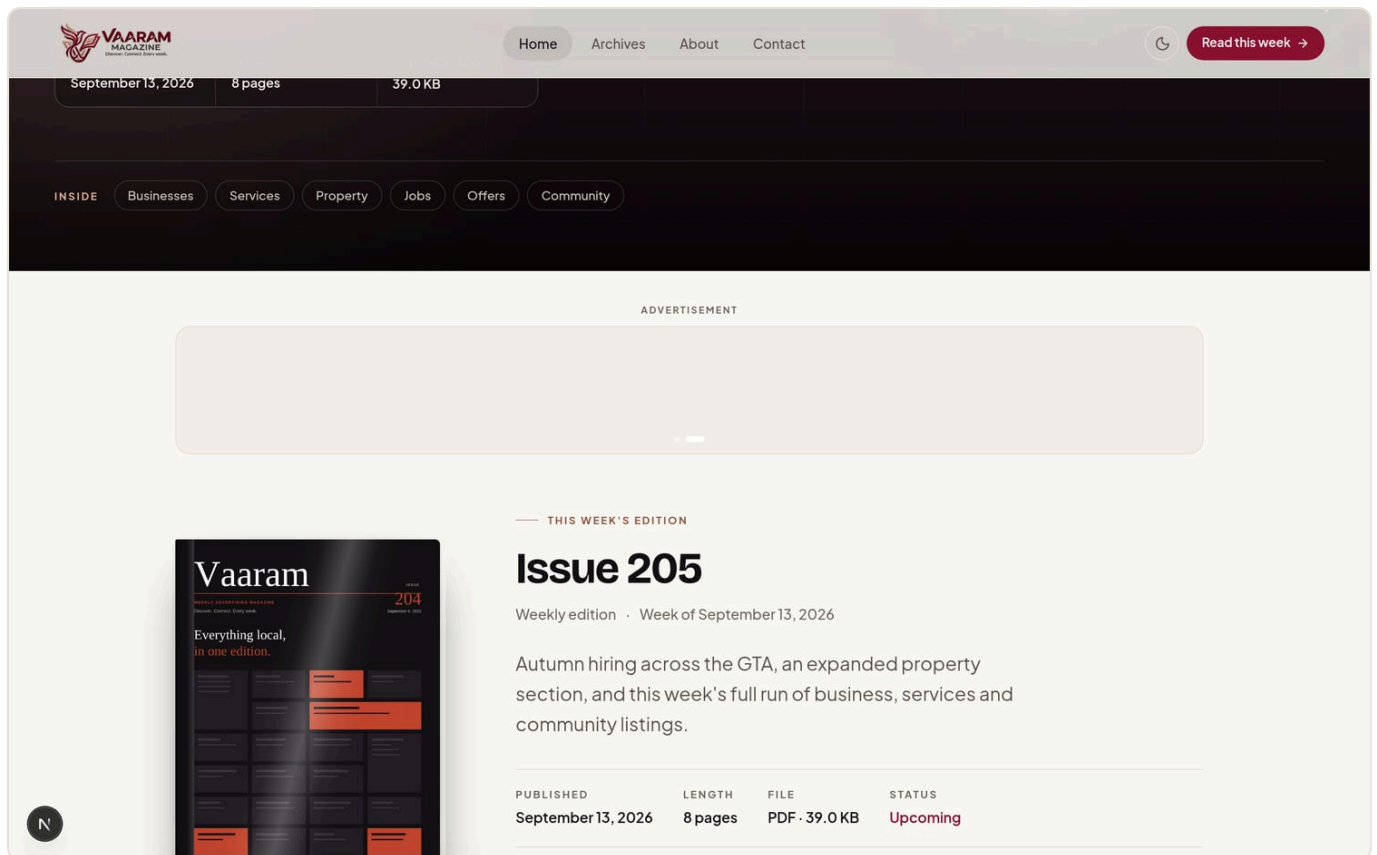


Figure 2.4 — bands 2 and 3: the first banner slot, then the current edition in full — cover, title, week, description, and three buttons: *Read now*, *View archives* and *Download*. Underneath: published date, page count, file size and status.

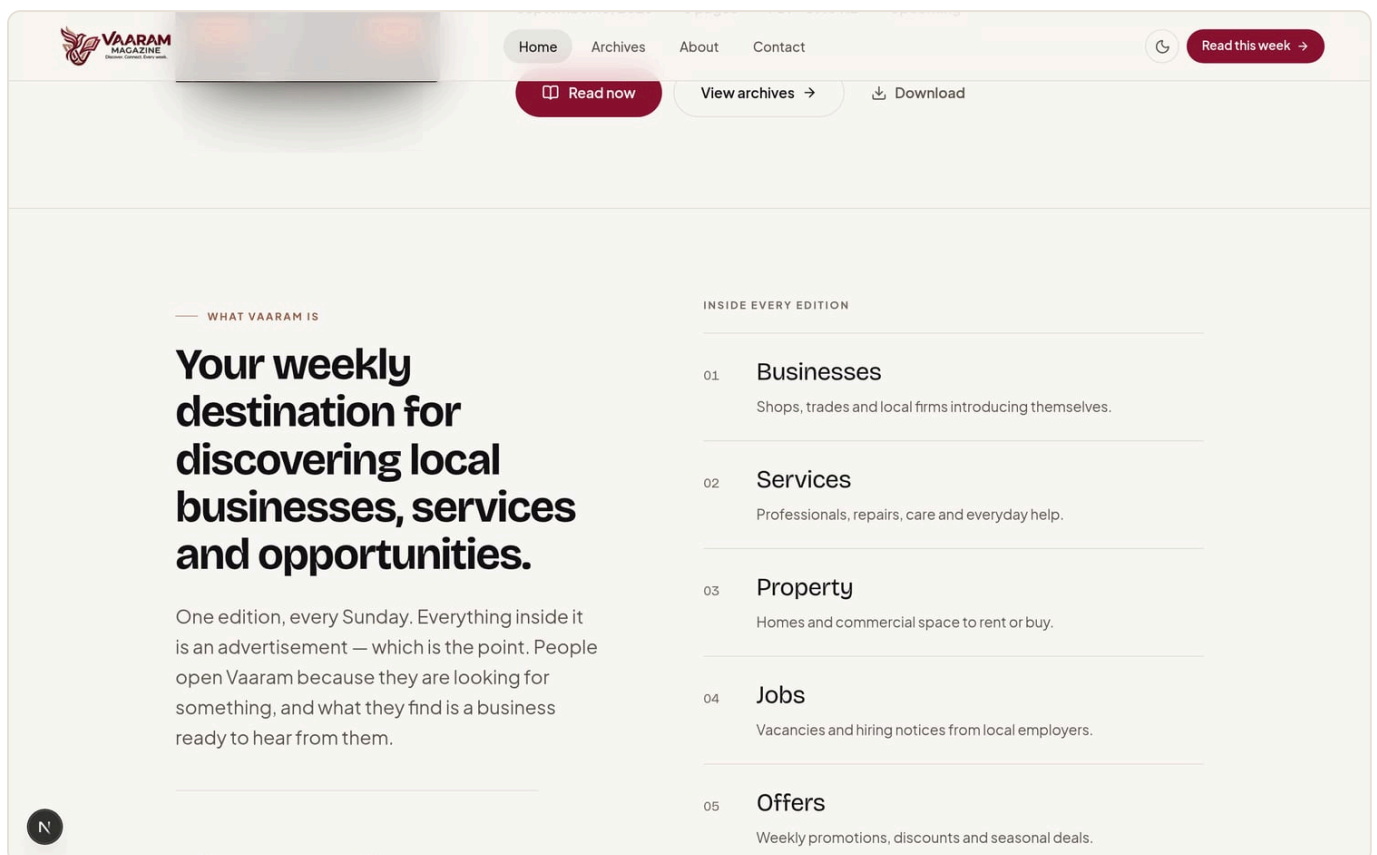


Figure 2.5 — band 4: “Your weekly destination for discovering local businesses, services and opportunities”, with the six numbered sections a reader will find inside — Businesses, Services, Property, Jobs, Offers, Community.

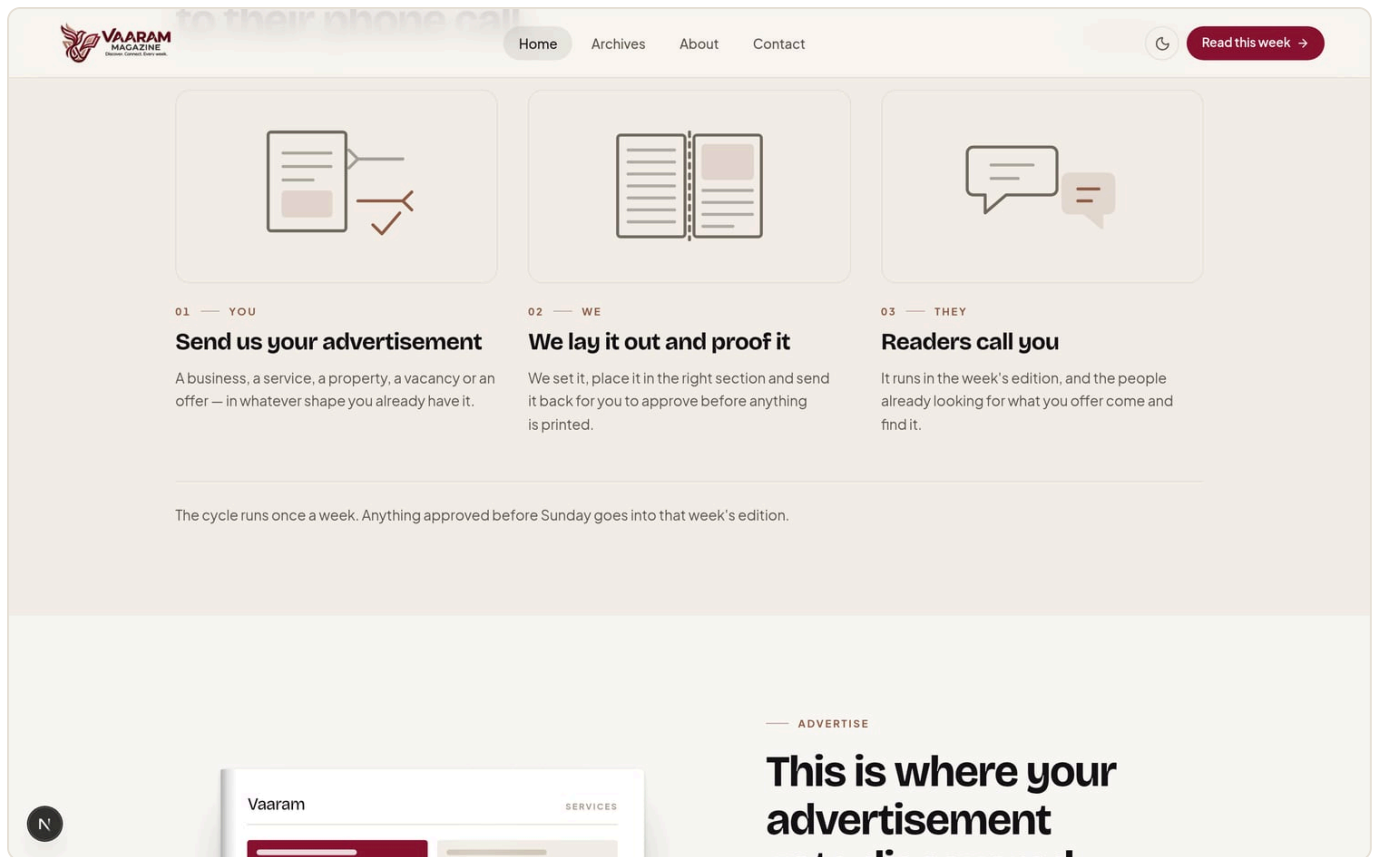


Figure 2.6 — bands 5 and 6: “From your advertisement to their phone call”, told in three steps — **01** you send us your advertisement, **02** we lay it out and proof it, **03** readers call you.

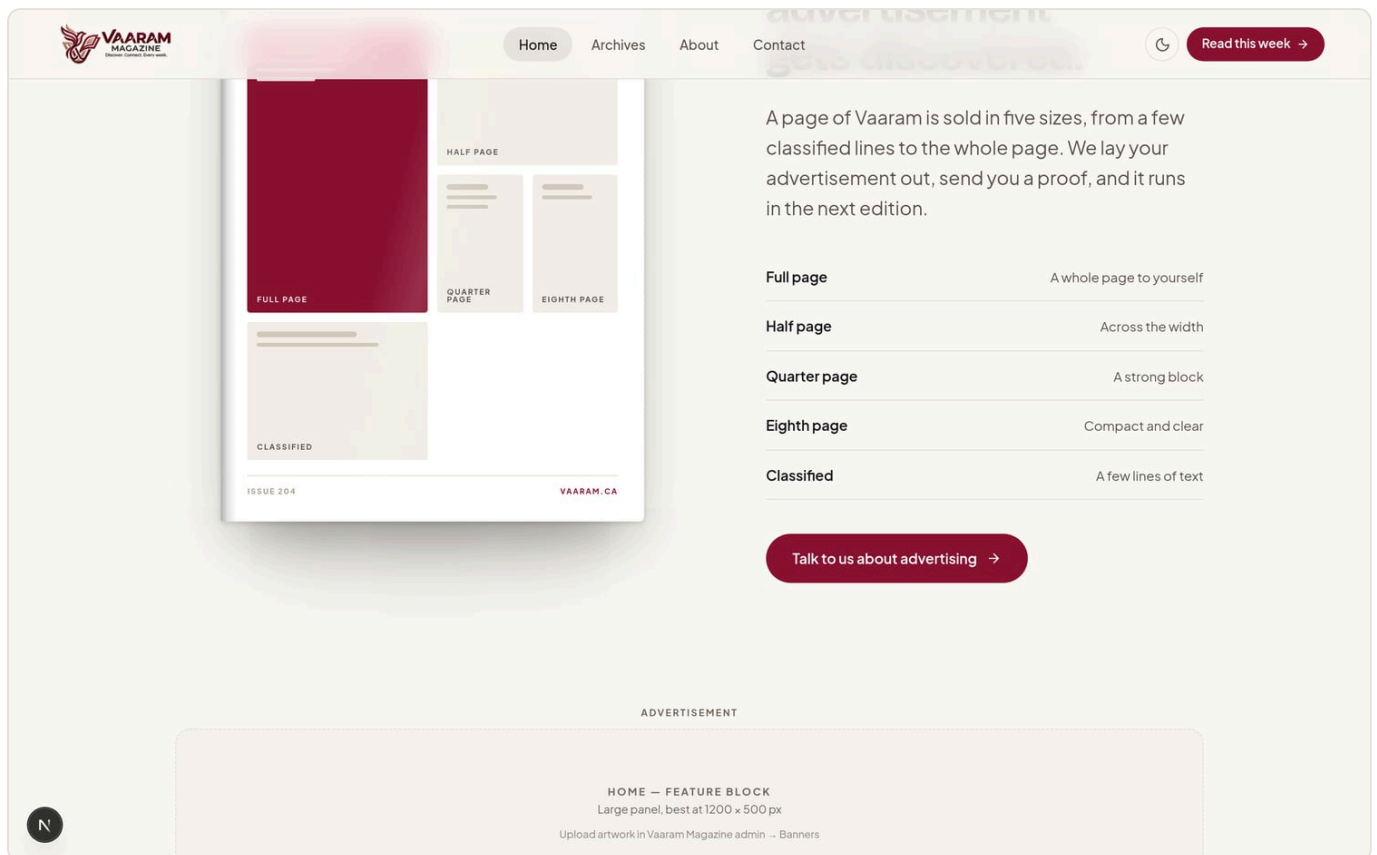


Figure 2.7 — band 7: the advertisement sizes sold inside the magazine — full page, half page, quarter page, eighth page and classified lines — each explained in a line, with a page diagram and a “Talk to us about advertising” button.

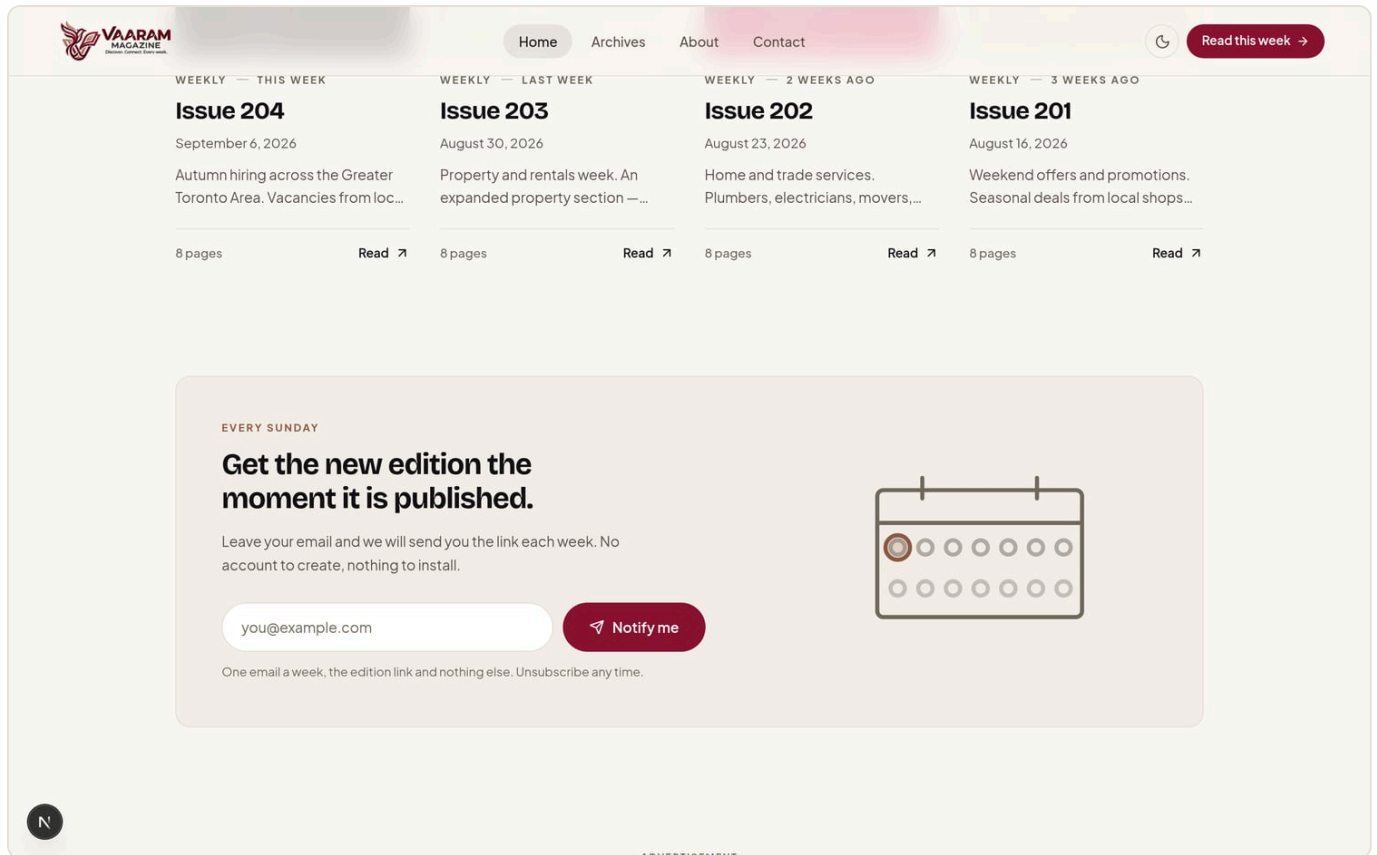


Figure 2.8 — bands 8 and 9: live publication statistics counted from the real archive — editions published, weeks running, pages of advertising, and “\$0 cost to read” — then the four most recent editions as cover cards.

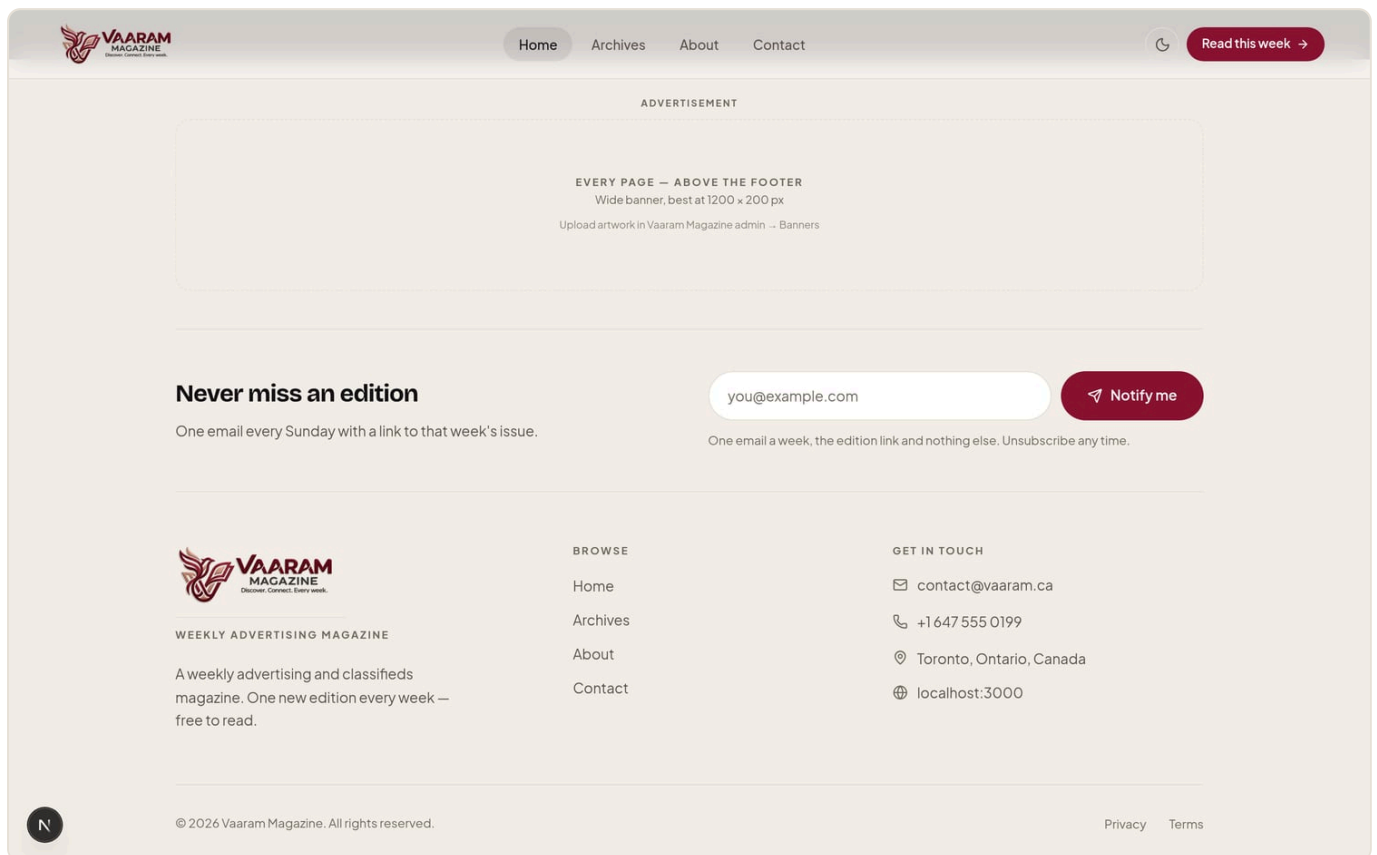


Figure 2.9 — bands 10 and 11: the sign-up band, the last banner slot, and the closing “Get your business discovered” panel in near-black, with buttons to Contact and About.

Four of the eleven bands are paid banner slots

Home carries **four** of the ten sellable placements: under the hero, mid page, the feature block, and above the closing call. In these screenshots they show a dashed outline because nothing is booked. On the live site an unbooked slot shows Vaaram's own “Want your advertisement in here?” panel instead — never an empty box.

2.3 Archives — grid, list, calendar and search

Every edition ever published stays here. Three ways to browse, one search box, and a year filter. Nothing needs maintaining — an edition appears the moment you publish it.

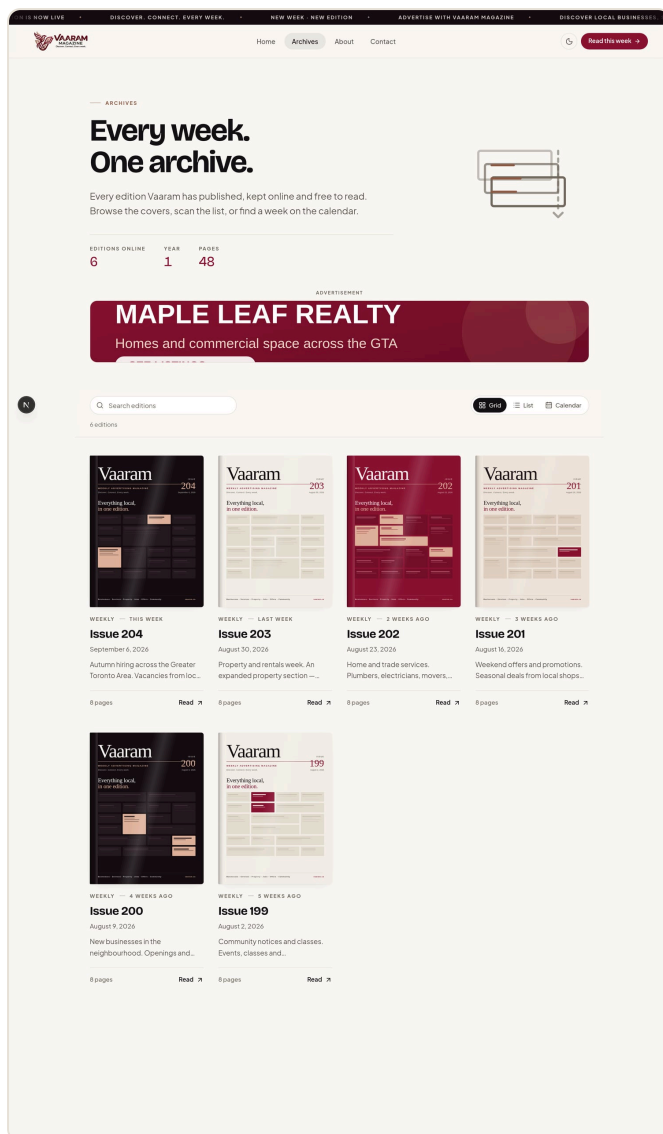


Figure 2.10 — Grid (the default). Covers at a glance, with issue title, date and freshness (“This week”, “Last week”, “3 weeks ago”).

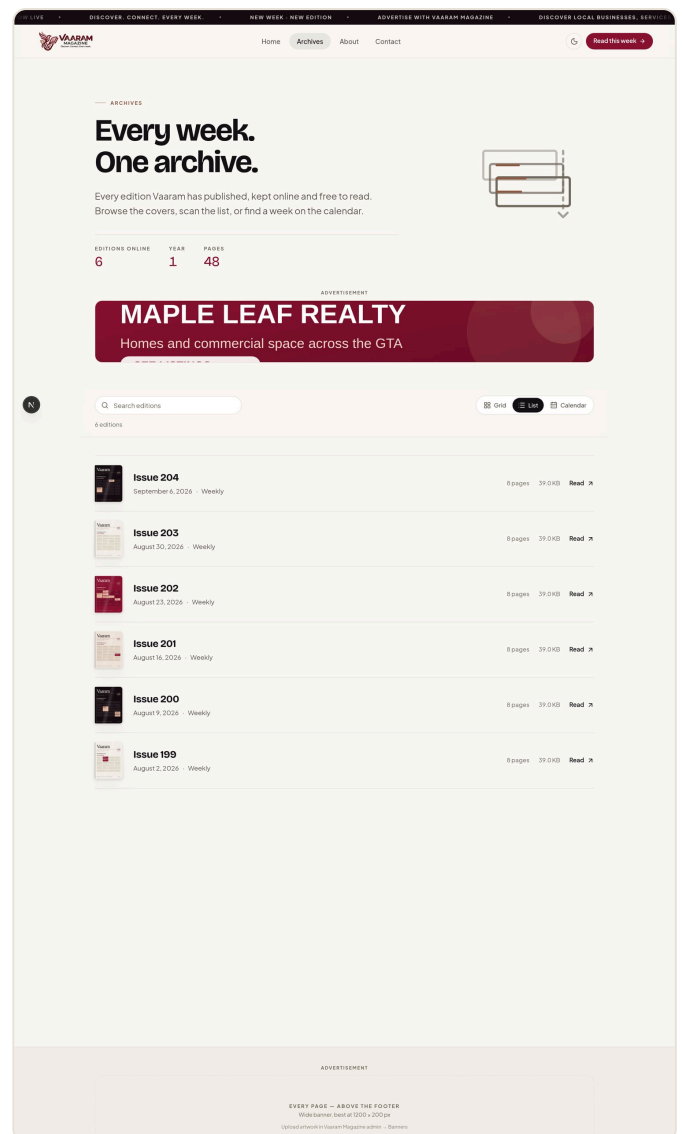


Figure 2.11 — List. Denser, with the description of each edition, best when the archive is long.

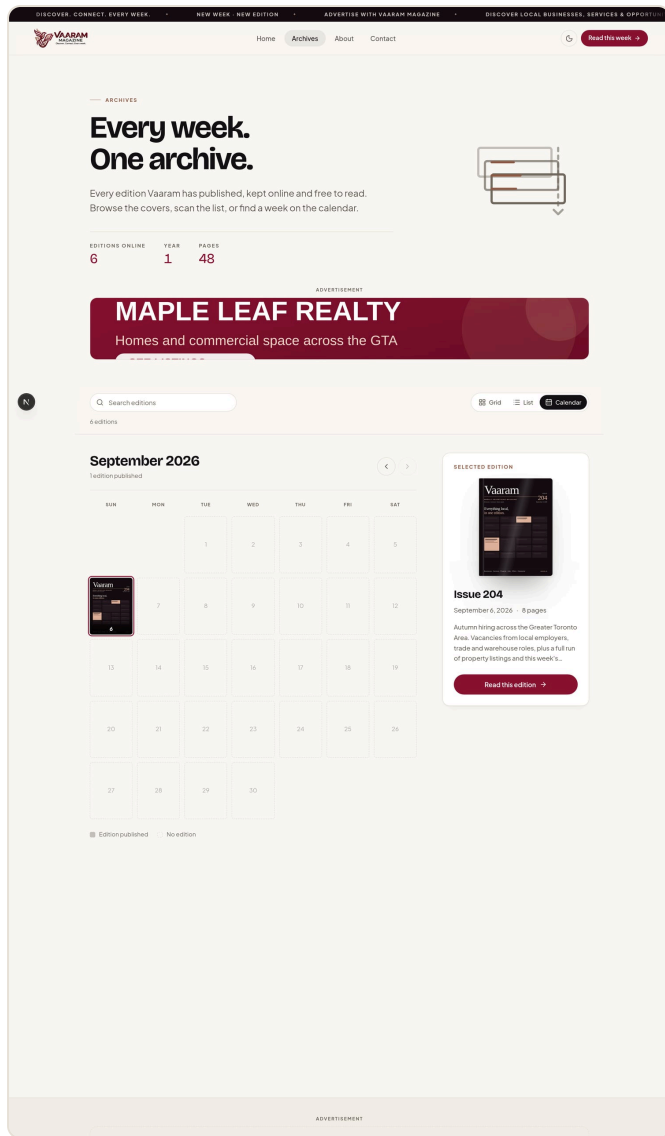


Figure 2.12 — Calendar. Editions plotted on the weeks of the year — the clearest proof that the magazine really does come out every week.

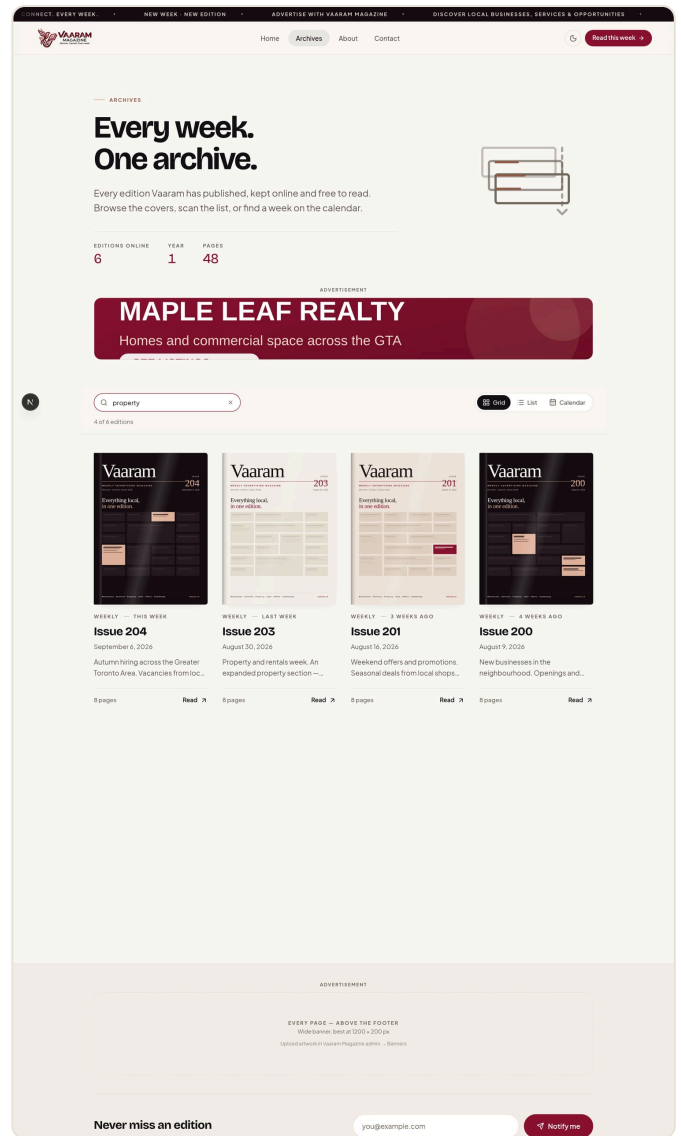


Figure 2.13 — Search. Filters by title and description as the reader types. Here “property” narrows the archive to the editions that mention it.

2.4 An edition page and the built-in reader

Every edition gets a permanent web address of its own — for example vaaram.ca/archives/2026-09-13-weekly-issue-205. This is the page you send to an advertiser, and the page a search engine indexes.

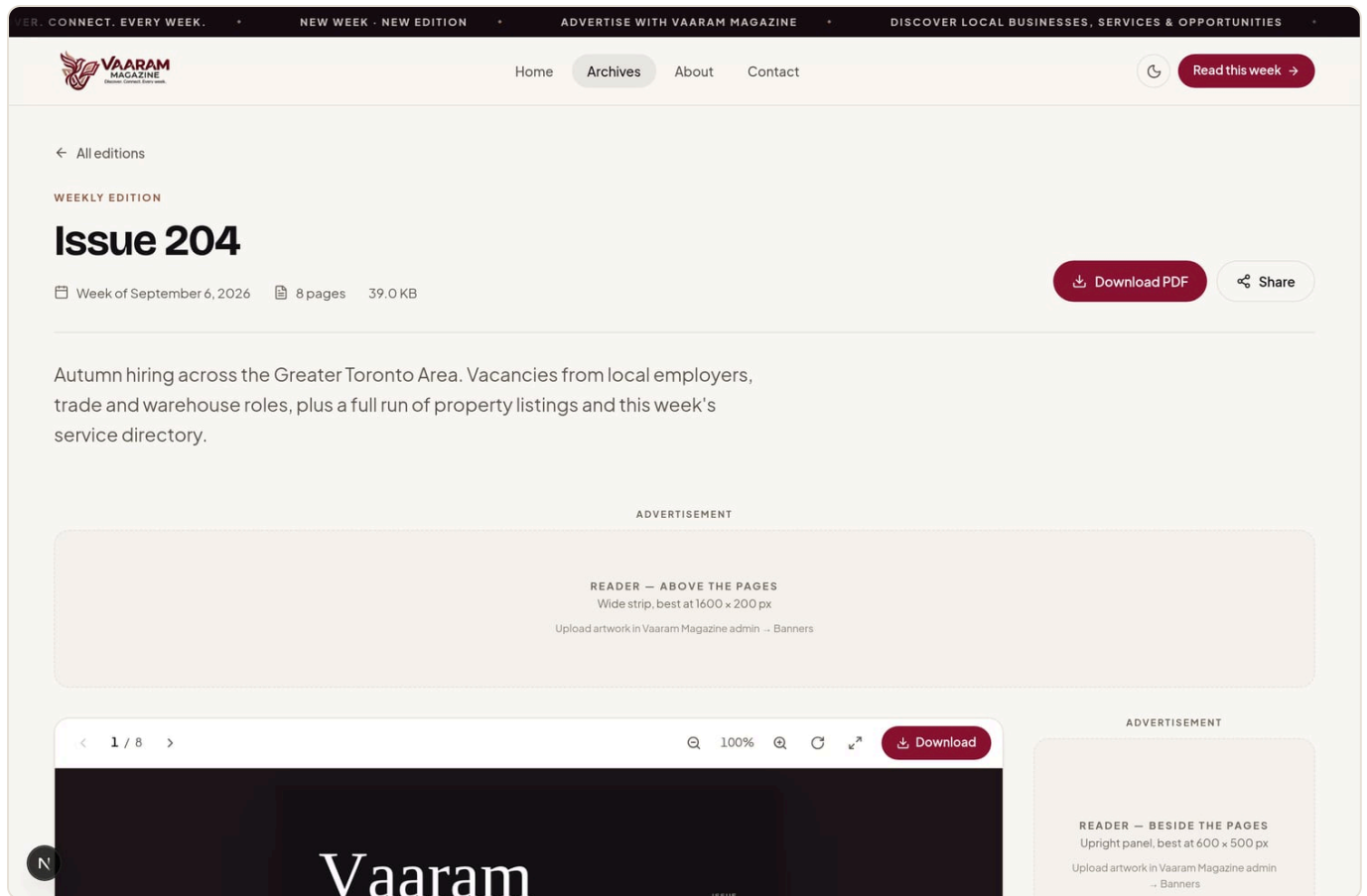
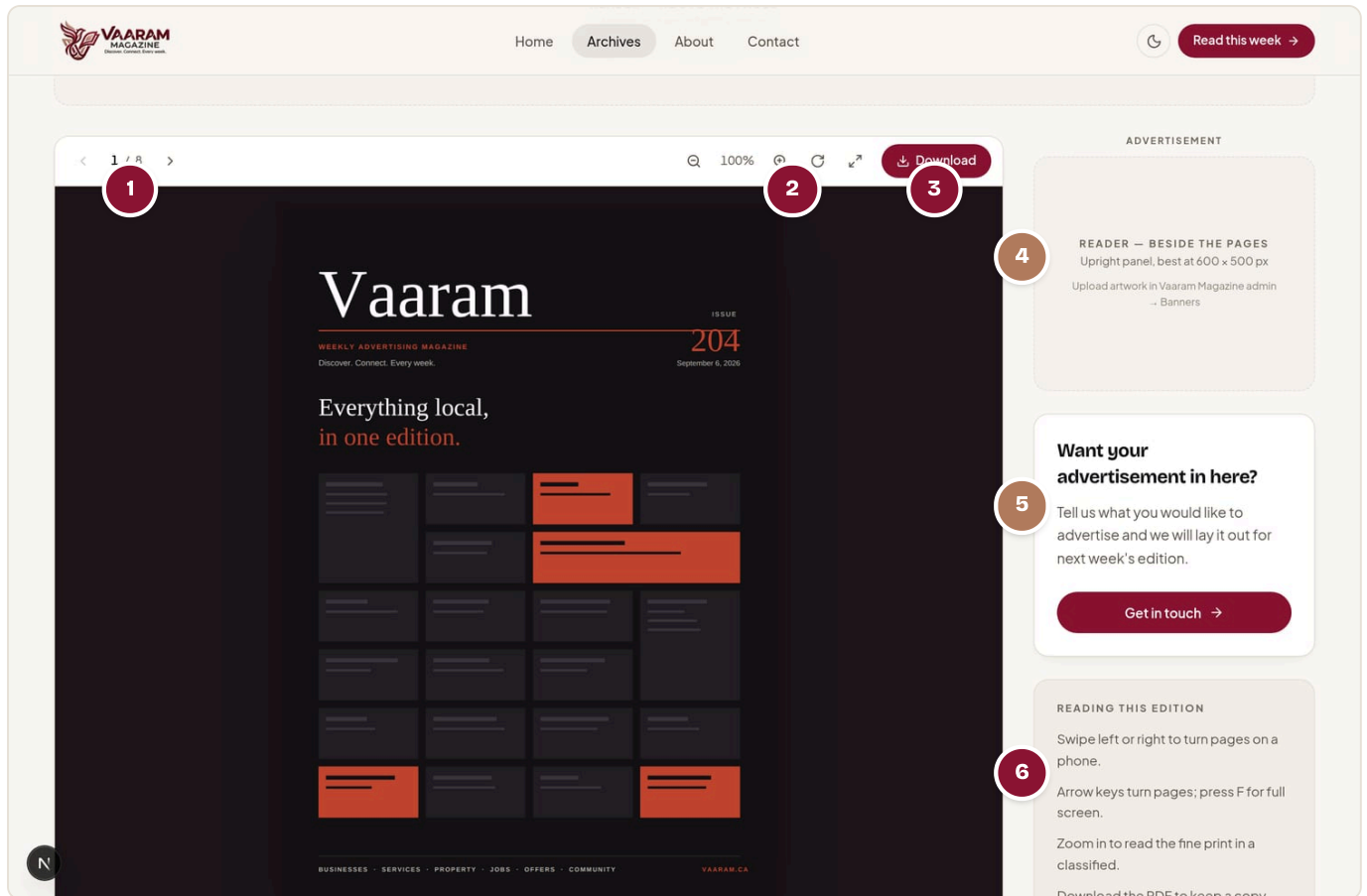


Figure 2.14 — the head of an edition page.



- 1 **Page turner.** Arrows either side of the live “1 / 8” count. Arrow keys work too; on a phone the reader swipes.
- 2 **Zoom out, zoom percentage, zoom in, rotate and full screen** — everything needed to read the fine print in a classified, or open a landscape spread. Pressing F also goes full screen.
- 3 **Download**, repeated here so a reader never has to scroll back up for it.
- 4 **Reader sidebar banner slot** — a paid, upright placement beside the pages that stays in view as pages turn.
- 5 **The house advertisement.** When nothing is booked in a slot the site sells the slot itself. This is what an empty placement looks like on the live site.
- 6 **“Reading this edition”** — four short instructions, so nobody has to work out the controls.

Figure 2.15 — the reader. The entire PDF is rendered inside the visitor's browser; nothing is uploaded to a third-party viewer, and no account is required.

Fixed during this review

While testing the reader for this document we found that the PDF engine bundled with the site relied on a browser feature that current versions of Chrome, Edge and Safari do not yet provide — pages rendered as black rectangles and the automatic cover thumbnail failed silently. The site now loads the compatibility build of the same engine. Both the reader and the cover generation were re-tested afterwards and work correctly; Figure 2.15 above and Figure 3.9 later are the re-tested results.

Below the reader

Under the pages sit two more banner slots (above and below the reader), then “More from the archive” — four other editions as cover cards, so a reader who has finished this week carries on into last week.

2.5 About

The page that sells the publication to a business. It answers one question in five ways: why should my advertisement be in a magazine made entirely of advertisements?

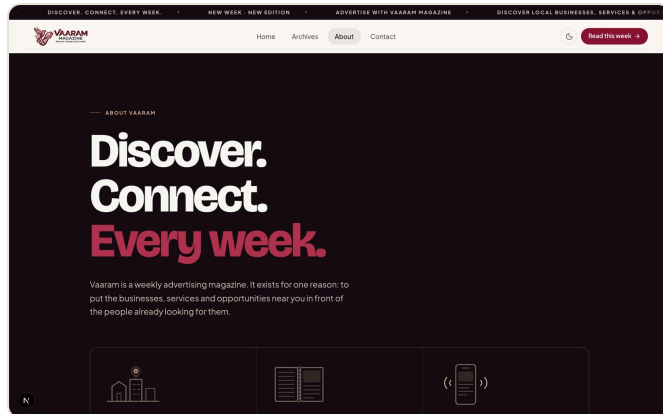


Figure 2.16 — the opening statement, and the three-icon summary of what the magazine is.

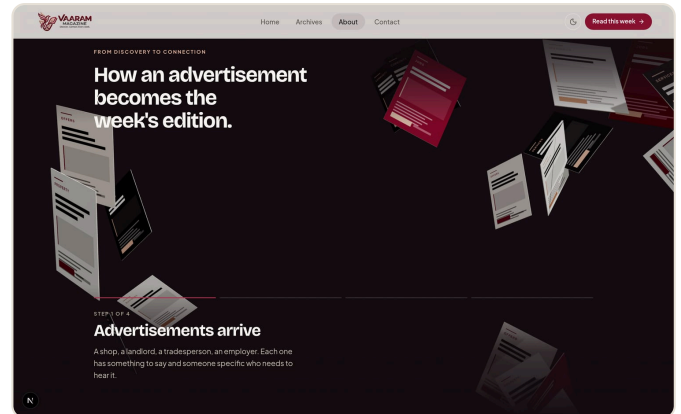


Figure 2.17 — a scroll-driven three-dimensional scene in four steps: advertisements arrive, are gathered and sorted, become pages, and the edition is published.

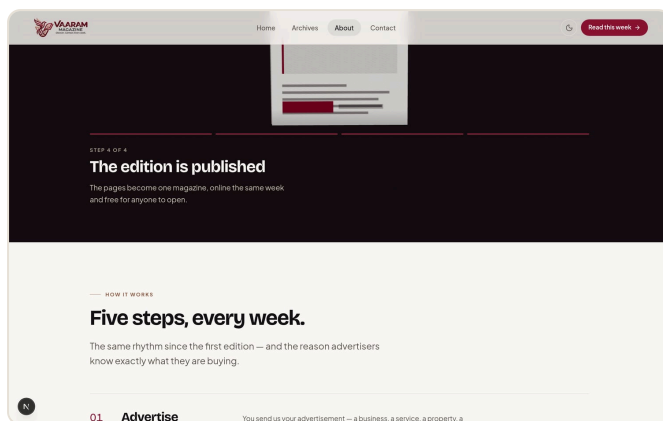


Figure 2.18 — “Five steps, every week”: Advertise, Curate, Publish, Discover, Connect — the same cycle as Part 1.2, written for an advertiser.

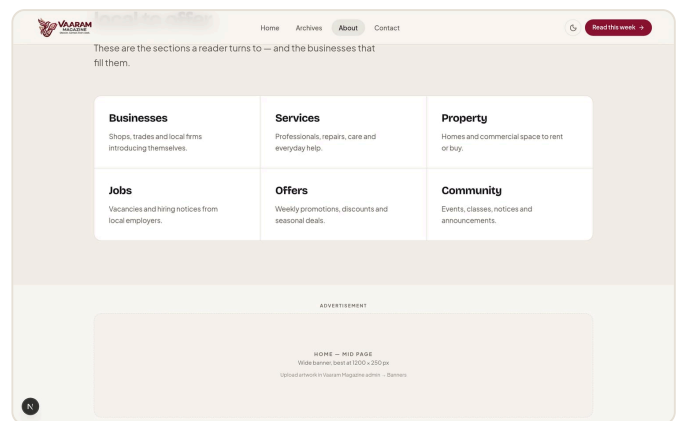


Figure 2.19 — “Anyone with something local to offer”, with the six sections and who belongs in each.

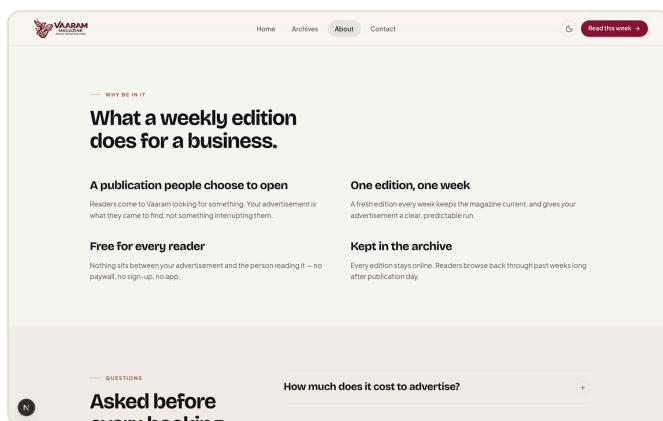


Figure 2.20 — four reasons a weekly edition works for a business: a publication people choose to open, one edition one week, free for every reader, kept in the archive.

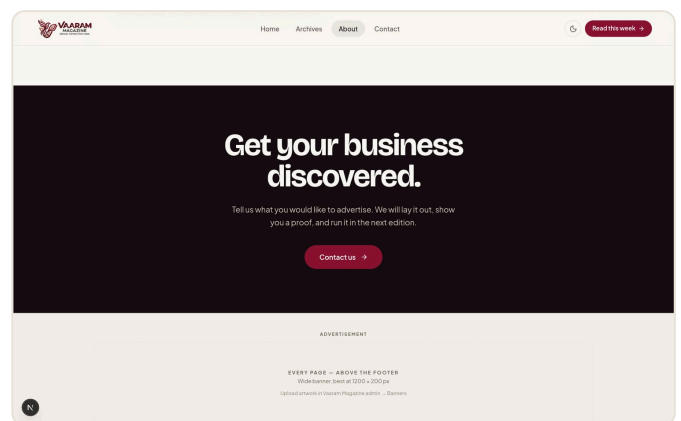


Figure 2.21 — the FAQ, answering the six questions asked before every booking. It is also published in the format Google reads for its answer boxes.

2.6 Contact, and what happens to an enquiry

Contact carries your direct details, the six frequently asked questions, and the form. The form is the only way a stranger can put data into your website, and it is the start of the enquiry workflow you will run every week.

The screenshot displays a contact page layout. On the left, a vertical list of contact details includes: PHONE (+1647 555 0199), WHATSAPP (Message our desk), EMAIL (contact@vaaram.ca), ADDRESS (Toronto, Ontario, Canada), and OFFICE HOURS (Monday – Saturday, 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM ET). Below this is a section titled 'Advertising in the next edition' with a sub-header 'N' and a paragraph: 'Send us what you want to say and roughly how much space you have in mind. We lay the advertisement out for you and send a proof to approve before it is published.' On the right, an enquiry form is shown with fields for YOUR NAME (Ravi Kumar), PHONE (+1 416 555 0173), EMAIL optional (ravi@kumarelectrical.ca), and WHAT ARE YOU ADVERTISING? (Services). A MESSAGE field contains the text: 'We are a licensed electrical contractor in Etobicoke. I would like a quarter page in the next two editions – please send sizes and prices.' A 'Send enquiry' button is at the bottom of the form, with a note below it: 'We only use these details to reply to your enquiry.'

Figure 2.22 — the middle of the contact page, with the form filled in exactly as a real advertiser would. Your direct details are on the left, the form on the right.

ON THIS PAGE	DETAIL
Reach us directly	Phone, WhatsApp (opens a chat with a message already written), email, address and office hours — down the left.
Your name · Phone	Both required. Phone rather than email is the required one, because that is how advertising actually gets booked.
Email · What are you advertising?	Email optional; the dropdown offers your six categories, or “Not sure yet”. Whatever they choose becomes the subject line you see in the dashboard.
Message	Required, up to 4,000 characters.
Send enquiry	One button. An invisible trap field on the same form catches automated robots, which are silently discarded.

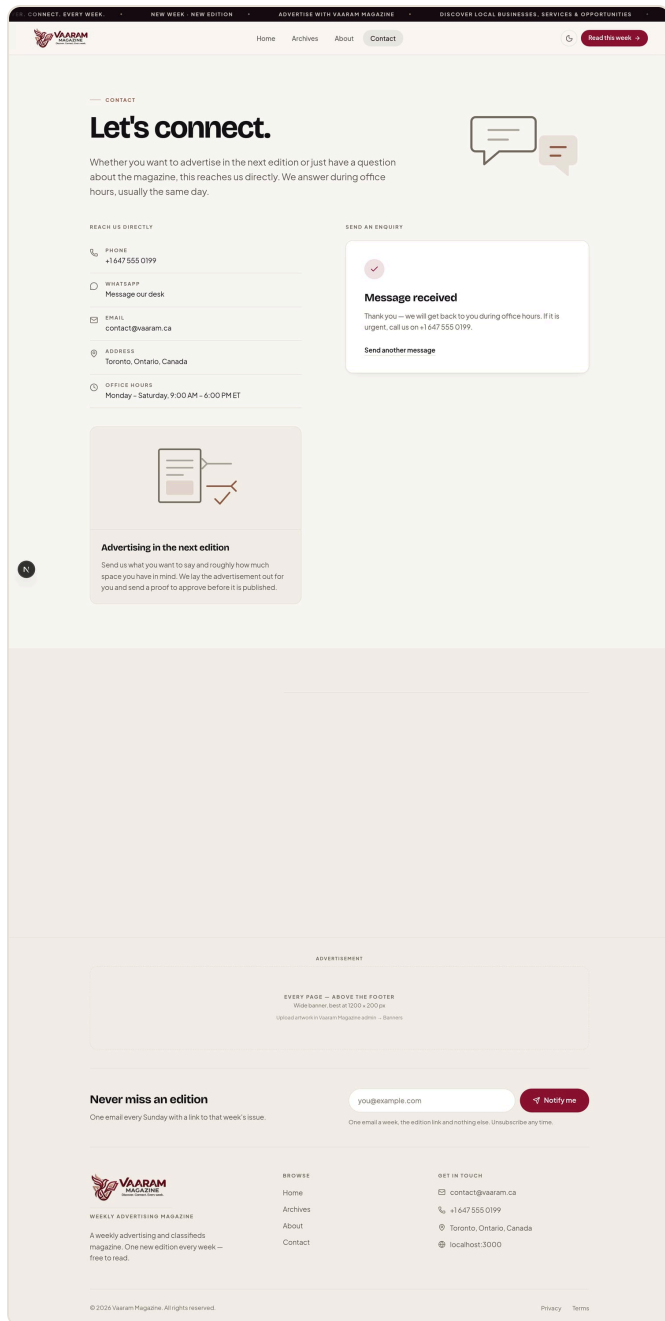


Figure 2.23 — what the sender sees immediately: “Message received”, with your phone number for anything urgent.

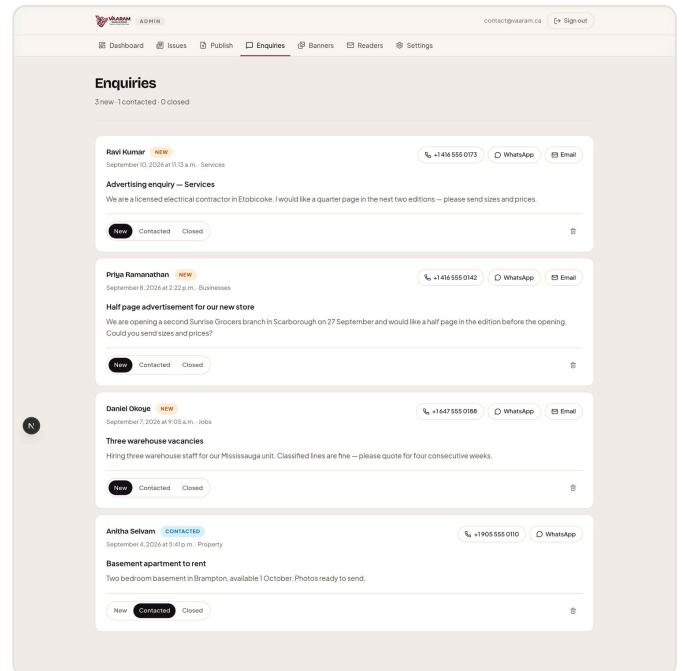


Figure 2.24 — the same message, seconds later, in Admin → Enquiries (top row). This is the real round trip, captured live.

Important — an enquiry is always saved, even with no email set up

Enquiries are written to your database first and shown in the dashboard. Emailing you a copy is an optional extra (Part 5.5). So even today, with no mailbox connected, no enquiry can be lost — but you would have to open the dashboard to see it. Setting up the mailbox is what turns that into a notification.

Protection already in place on the form

- A hidden trap field that only automated robots fill in — those submissions are accepted silently and thrown away, so the robot never learns it was caught.
- A limit of six messages every ten minutes from the same visitor, so nobody can flood the table. A person correcting a typo is never blocked.

- Every field is trimmed and cut to a maximum length before it is stored.
- The same protections, with a limit of five, are on the newsletter sign-up box.

2.7 Privacy, Terms and “page not found”

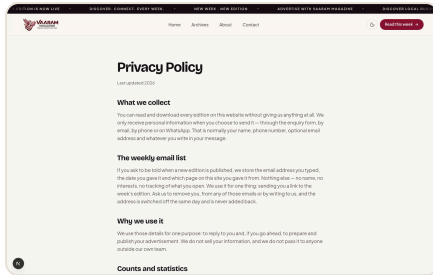


Figure 2.25 — Privacy. Written to match what the site actually does: no advertising cookies, no visitor profiles, only aggregate counters.

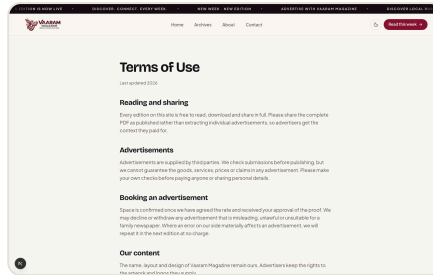


Figure 2.26 — Terms of use.

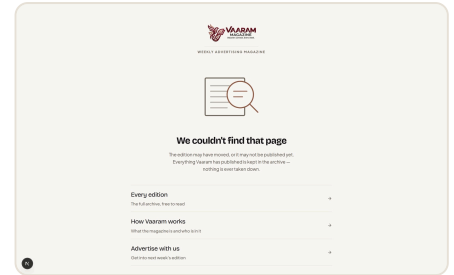


Figure 2.27 — a mistyped address gets a branded page with a way back, not a browser error.

Please read Privacy and Terms before launch

Both are complete and written specifically for this publication, but they are legal text published in your name. Read them once and tell us anything you want changed — particularly the business name and address that appear in them.

2.8 On a phone, and in dark mode

Every page was built for a phone first — most readers of a local advertising magazine will open it on one. The reader, the archive and the admin dashboard all work at phone width.

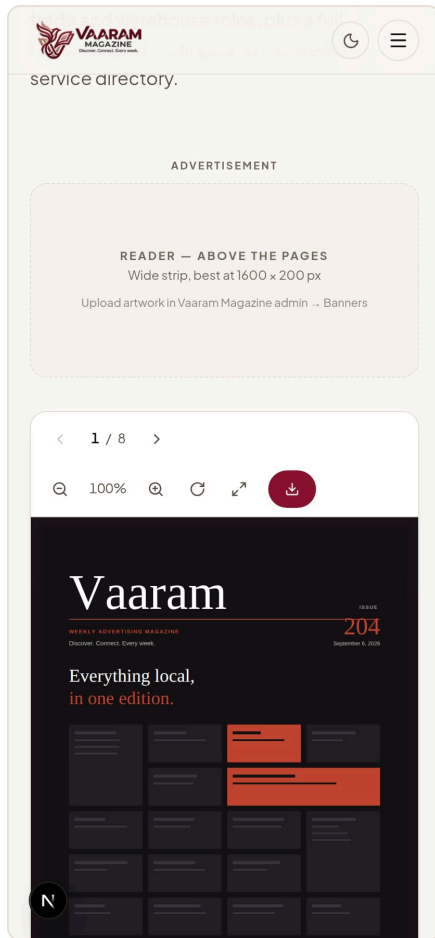


Figure 2.28 — the reader on a phone: swipe to turn pages.

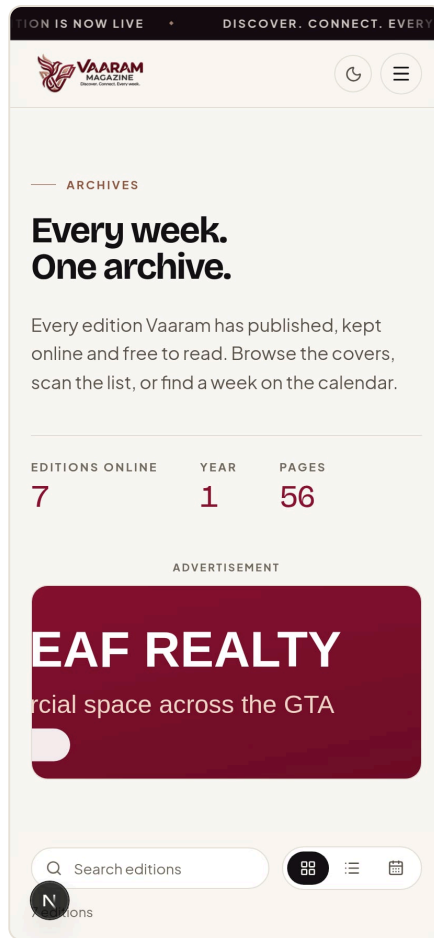


Figure 2.29 — the archive on a phone.

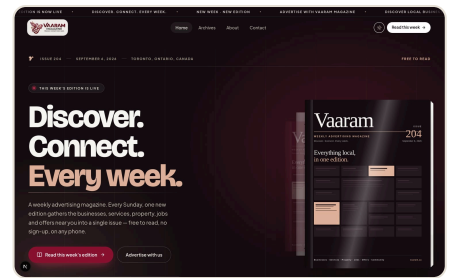


Figure 2.30 — dark mode. Every colour has a second, hand-checked value; nothing is auto-inverted.

2.9 What Google and Facebook see

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES
Sitemap	An automatic <code>/sitemap.xml</code> listing every page and every published edition, refreshed hourly, so new editions are found quickly.
Robots file	Search engines are allowed everywhere except <code>/admin</code> and the internal <code>/api</code> addresses.
Structured data	Each edition is described in the format Google understands for a periodical issue; the FAQ on the contact page is published as structured questions and answers.
Social share card	A branded image is generated for links shared on WhatsApp, Facebook or LinkedIn.
Per-edition titles	Every edition page has its own title and description — your “short description” is what Google shows underneath the link.
Old links kept alive	Earlier addresses (<code>/editions</code> , <code>/advertise</code>) permanently redirect to the current pages, so nothing already shared breaks.
Installable	A web app manifest means a reader can add Vaaram to their phone's home screen.

03

The admin dashboard

This is your operating manual. Seven screens, one job each. Everything here was performed for real while writing this document — the screenshots are the actual result of the actual clicks, in order.

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| 3.11 | Readers — the newsletter list |
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| 3.12 | Settings |
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| 3.13 | Every field, every limit |
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- | | |
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| 3.14 | Messages you may see |
|-------------|----------------------|
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3.1 Signing in

The dashboard lives at vaaram.ca/admin. It is not linked from anywhere on the public site, it is blocked from search engines, and every address that is not the login page bounces you to the login page unless you are signed in.

YOUR ADMINISTRATOR ACCOUNT

Web address	<code>https://vaaram.ca/admin</code>
Email	<code>contact@vaaram.ca</code>
Password	<code>Vaaram27#</code>
Who can sign in	Only addresses invited in the Supabase dashboard. Public sign-up is switched off — a stranger who guesses the address cannot create an account.

Two things to do about this password

1. Change it after launch, from the Supabase dashboard, and do not reuse it anywhere else. 2. This account can only be created once the Supabase project exists (Part 5.5) — until then these details cannot be tested against a live server. Everything shown in this part was captured against the real dashboard software running locally.

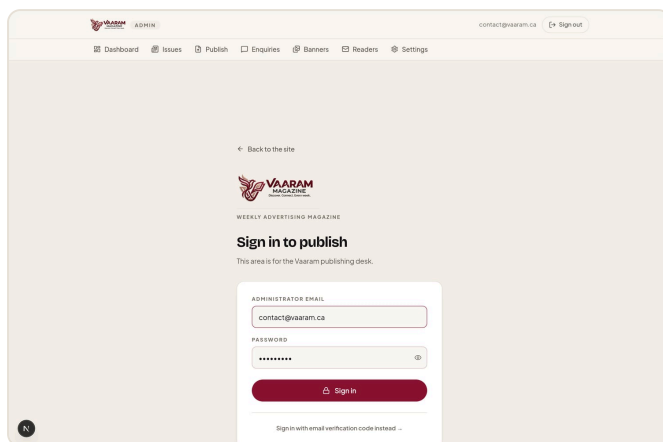


Figure 3.1 — method one: email and password. Administrator email, then password (the eye reveals it while you check), then **Sign in**. The link underneath switches to the second method.

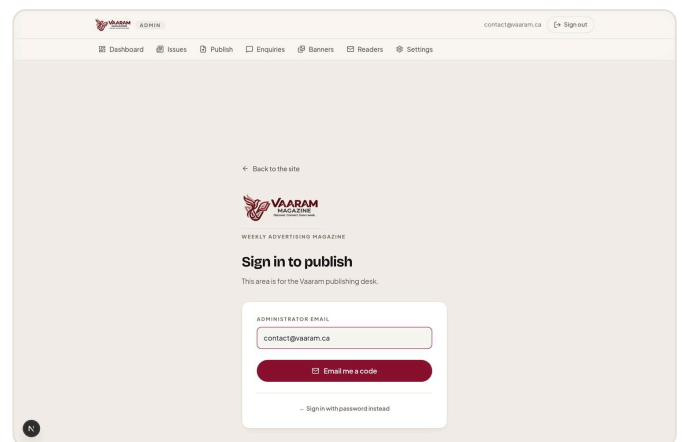


Figure 3.2 — method two: a six-digit code is emailed to the same address and typed in. Useful if the password is ever forgotten, or on a computer you would rather not type a password into. A new code can be requested after 45 seconds. **This method needs the mailbox to be working** (Part 5.4).

3.2 The map of the dashboard

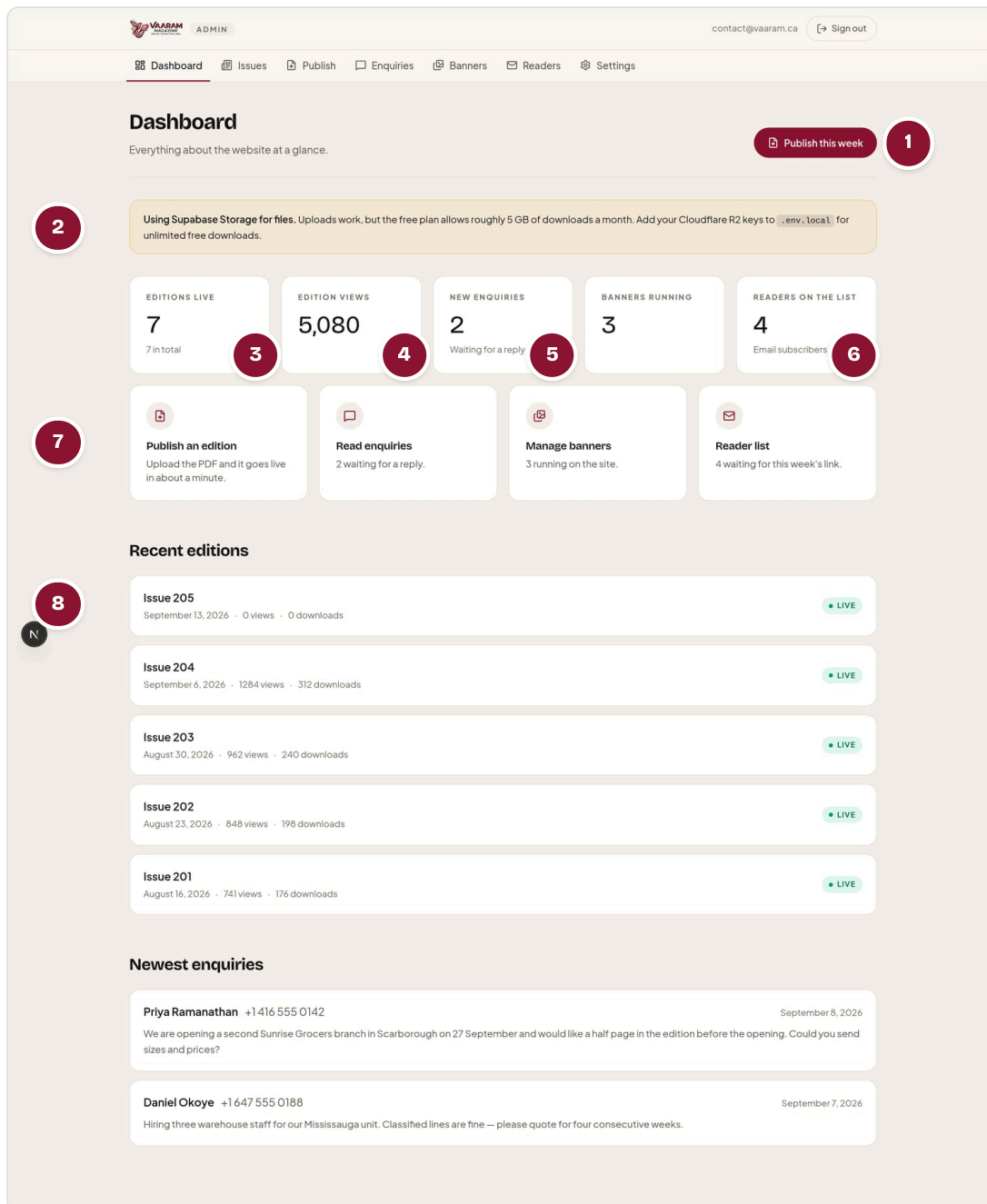
Seven sections, always along the top of the screen. Your signed-in address and the sign-out button sit above them.

SECTION	ADDRESS	WHAT YOU DO THERE
Dashboard	<code>/admin</code>	The week at a glance: five numbers, four shortcuts, recent editions, newest enquiries.
Issues	<code>/admin/issues</code>	Every edition ever created. Publish, unpublish, edit, preview or delete each one.
Publish	<code>/admin/issues/new</code>	The weekly job: upload this week's PDF and put it live.
Enquiries	<code>/admin/enquiries</code>	Every message from the contact form, with call / WhatsApp / email buttons and a status.
Banners	<code>/admin/banners</code>	Add and manage paid advertisements placed on the website itself.
Readers	<code>/admin/subscribers</code>	The newsletter list, with a one-click copy of every active address.
Settings	<code>/admin/settings</code>	Read-only: what the site is connected to and what is missing.

There is no “save” button hiding anywhere

Every action in the dashboard takes effect immediately and the public site refreshes itself within about a minute. Nothing sits in a pending state waiting to be pushed live.

3.3 Dashboard — what every number means



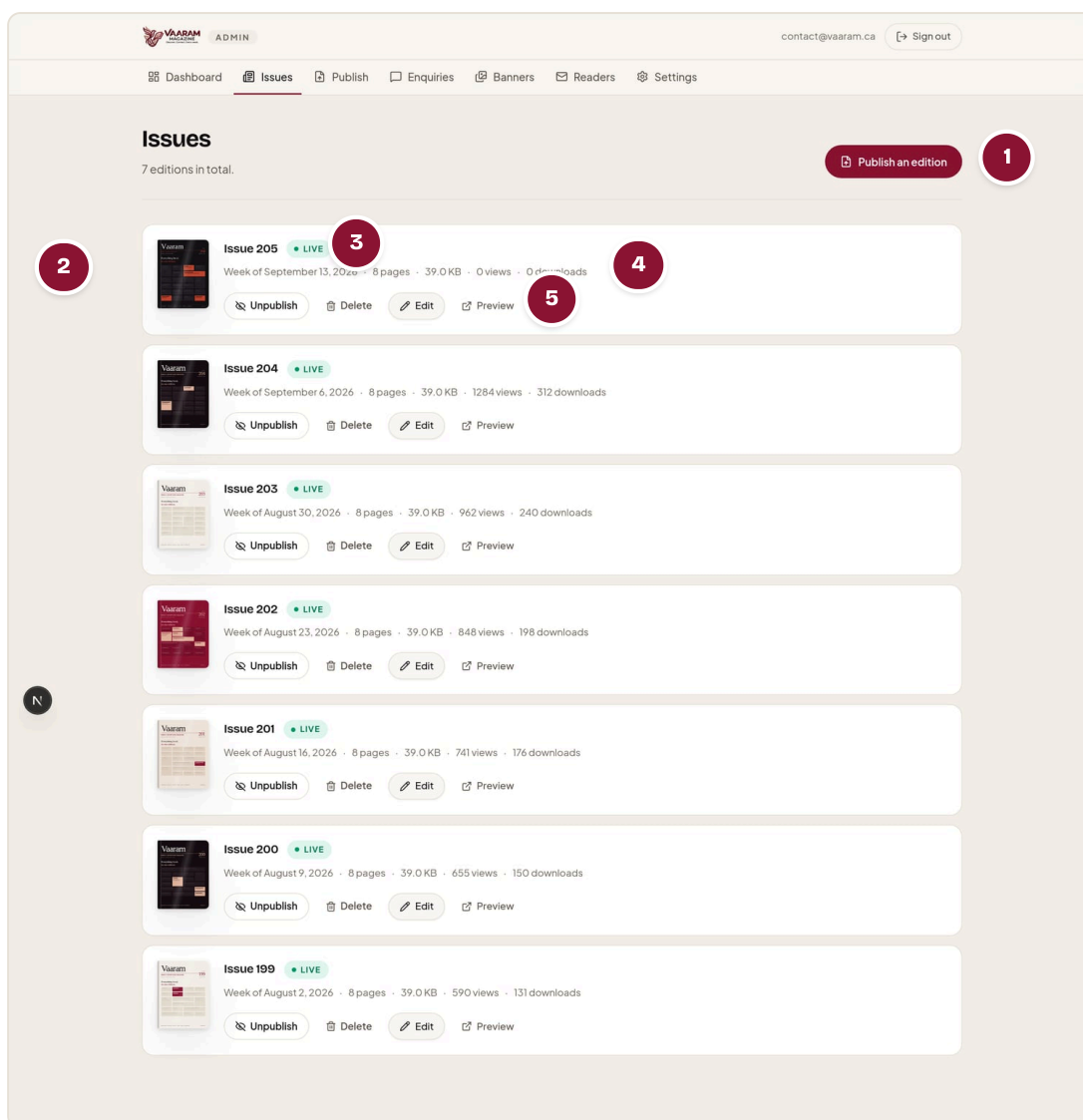
- 1 Publish this week.** The one button you will use most. Straight to the upload screen.
- 2 The storage notice.** Appears while the site is using Supabase Storage rather than Cloudflare R2. It is a reminder, not a fault — see Part 4.
- 3 Editions live** — how many are visible to readers, with the total including drafts underneath.
- 4 Edition views** — every time anyone opened an edition page, added up across the archive.
- 5 New enquiries** — messages you have not marked as contacted yet. This is your to-do count.
- 6 Banners running** and **Readers on the list** complete the five.
- 7 Four shortcuts**, each carrying a live count so you can see whether it needs attention before you click.
- 8 Recent editions** — the five newest, each with its own views and downloads and a LIVE or DRAFT tag. Below them, the newest enquiries in full.

Figure 3.3 — the dashboard, immediately after publishing Issue 205 (note it shows 0 views, 0 downloads — it is brand new).

What the counters do and do not record

Views, downloads, banner impressions and banner clicks are plain running totals. No cookie is set, no IP address is stored, no visitor is identified or followed. That is a deliberate choice: it keeps the numbers honest enough to quote to an advertiser, and it is why the site needs no cookie banner.

3.4 Issues — the list of every edition



1 Publish an edition — same destination as “Publish” in the menu.

2 The cover thumbnail, made from page 1 of that edition's PDF.

3 LIVE or DRAFT. Green means readers can see it.

4 The facts line — week, pages, file size, views, downloads.

5 The four row actions. **Unpublish** hides the edition from the public site instantly — nothing is deleted, and the button becomes “Publish”. **Delete** asks you to confirm first (Figure 3.5). **Edit** opens the edition's details. **Preview** opens the public page in a new tab.

Figure 3.4 — Issues, showing the newly published Issue 205 at the top.

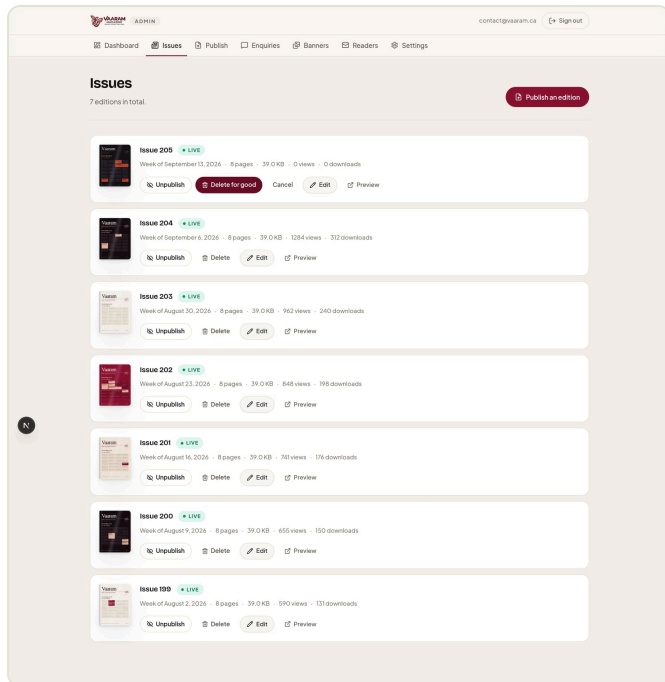


Figure 3.5 — Delete asks twice. The button changes to “Delete for good” with a Cancel beside it. Only the second click removes the edition.

What delete actually removes

It removes the edition’s *record*— the page disappears from the site, the archive and the sitemap immediately. The PDF file itself is deliberately left in storage, so an accidental delete never destroys the only copy of an edition. If you truly want the file gone as well, tell us and we will remove it from the bucket.

Unpublish versus delete

Nine times out of ten **Unpublish** is what you want: it takes the edition off the site but keeps every detail, every counter and the file, ready to put back with one click. Use Delete only for something created by mistake.

3.5 Worked example: publishing this week's PDF edition

This is the weekly job, start to finish. Everything below actually happened, in this order, and each screenshot is the real screen at that moment. From opening the page to the edition being live took under a minute.

THE EXAMPLE WE ARE PUBLISHING

The file	sample.pdf · 39.0 KB · 8 pages
Edition title	Issue 205
Edition	Weekly
Publication date	13 September 2026 (a Sunday)
Short description	Autumn hiring across the GTA, an expanded property section, and this week's full run of business, services and community listings.
Action	Publish edition

A real Vaaram edition will be a much larger file — typically 20 to 40 pages and 8 to 30 MB. The steps and the screens are identical; only the upload takes longer.

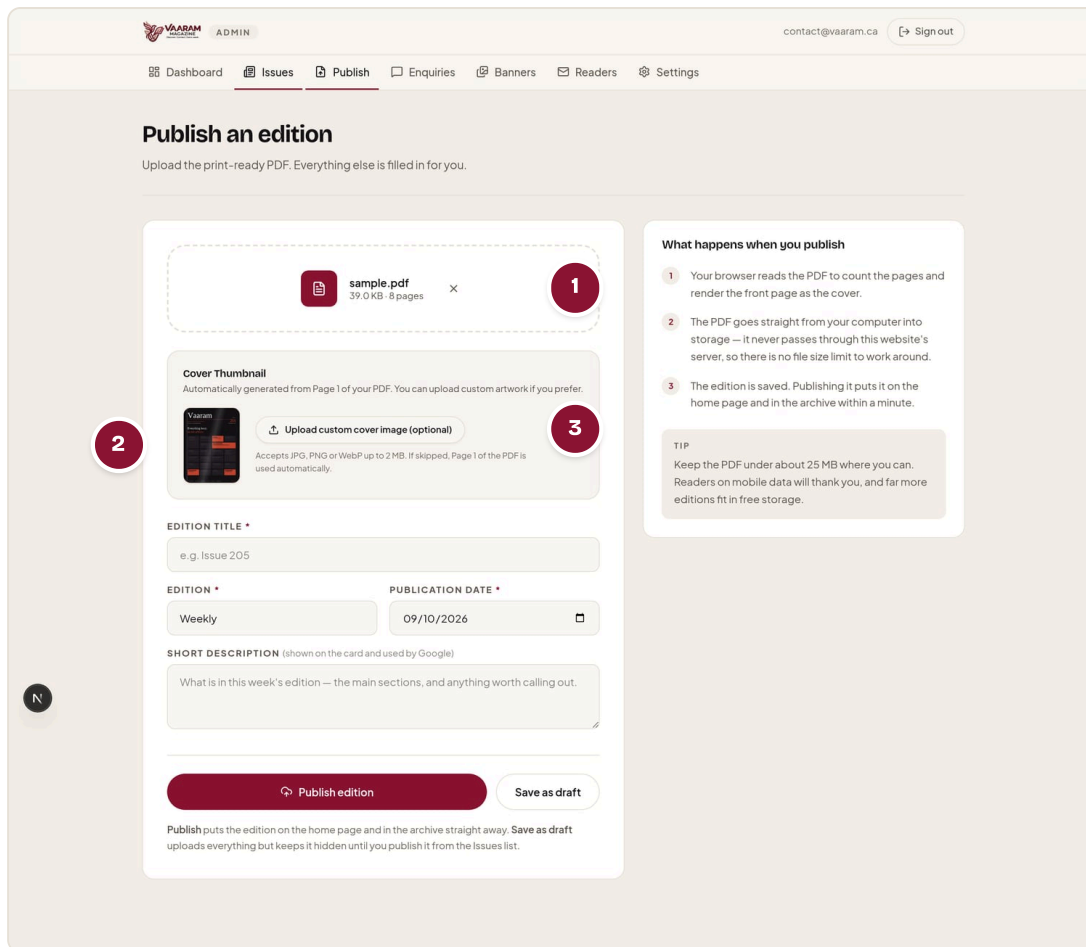
1 Open Admin → Publish

You get an empty upload area on the left and, on the right, a three-line reminder of what publishing does. Nothing is filled in yet and both buttons at the bottom are greyed out until a PDF is chosen.

Figure 3.6 — step 1: the empty form. The upload area and the six fields run down the left; the panel on the right, “What happens when you publish”, repeats the three steps and the file-size tip so they are always on screen. Every field is named in Figure 3.8.

2 Drop the PDF in

The moment the file is chosen, your own browser opens it, counts the pages and draws page 1 into a small cover picture. Nothing has been uploaded yet — this all happens on your computer. The file name, size and page count appear in the drop zone, and the cover preview fills in beside “Cover Thumbnail”.



1 The chosen file, with its name and “**39.0 KB · 8 pages**” underneath — the page count was read out of the PDF, not typed by you. The small **X** removes the file if you picked the wrong one.

2 The generated cover — page 1, rendered as a picture about 900 pixels wide. This becomes the thumbnail everywhere on the site.

3 “Upload custom cover image (optional)” — only if you want different artwork on the cover card than the actual front page. JPG, PNG or WebP, up to 2 MB.

Figure 3.7 — step 2: the PDF has been read. Still nothing has left your computer.

3 Fill in the four details

Title, edition, date, description. The date defaults to today; change it to the Sunday the edition belongs to if you are publishing early or late.

Publish an edition
Upload the print-ready PDF. Everything else is filled in for you.

sample.pdf
39.0 KB · 8 pages

Cover Thumbnail
Automatically generated from Page 1 of your PDF. You can upload custom artwork if you prefer.

Upload custom cover image (optional)
Accepts JPG, PNG or WebP up to 2 MB. If skipped, Page 1 of the PDF is used automatically.

EDITION TITLE *
Issue 205

EDITION *
Weekly

PUBLICATION DATE *
09/13/2026

SHORT DESCRIPTION (shown on the card and used by Google)
Autumn hiring across the GTA, an expanded property section, and this week's full run of business, services and community listings.

Publish edition **Save as draft**

What happens when you publish

- 1 Your browser reads the PDF to count the pages and render the front page as the cover.
- 2 The PDF goes straight from your computer into storage — it never passes through this website's server, so there is no file size limit to work around.
- 3 The edition is saved. Publishing it puts it on the home page and in the archive within a minute.

TIP
Keep the PDF under about 25 MB where you can. Readers on mobile data will thank you, and far more editions fit in free storage.

- 1 **Edition title:** Issue 205
- 2 **Edition:** Weekly
- 3 **Publication date:** 13/09/2026
- 4 **Short description** — two sentences is ideal; the limit is 500 characters.
- 5 **Publish edition** — live immediately.
- 6 **Save as draft** — everything is uploaded, but readers cannot see it until you publish it from the Issues list.

Figure 3.8 — step 3: every field completed, ready to publish.

- 4 **Press “Publish edition” and watch the bar**
Four things happen in order, and the wording under the progress bar tells you which one you are in: reading the PDF, uploading the PDF, uploading the cover picture, and saving. A 20 MB edition on a normal office connection takes roughly 30–60 seconds. **Do not close the tab** while the bar is moving.

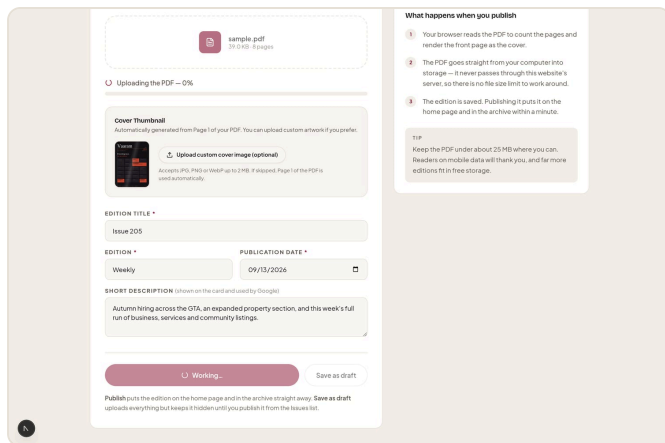


Figure 3.9 — step 4: uploading. The percentage is the real transfer of the file to storage.

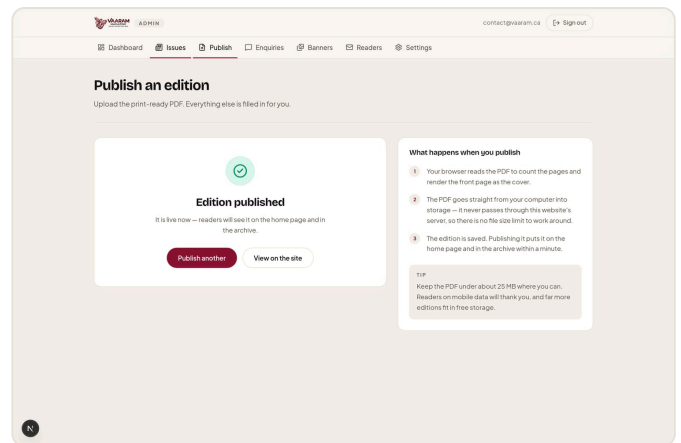


Figure 3.10 — step 5: done. “Edition published — it is live now.” *Publish another* clears the form; *View on the site* opens the public archive.

What the website did with what you typed

YOU GAVE	THE SITE PRODUCED
The PDF file	Uploaded straight from your browser into storage under a name it generated: <code>editions/2026-09-13-a4f2c19b-sample.pdf</code> . The random middle part means two files with the same name can never overwrite each other.
Nothing	8 pages and 39.0 KB , both read from the file, both displayed to readers.
Nothing	A cover picture from page 1, uploaded to <code>images/</code> , used on the home page, the archive cards and the social share.
Title, edition, date	The edition's permanent web address: <code>/archives/2026-09-13-weekly-issue-205</code> (built from date + edition + title, lower-cased, spaces turned into hyphens, and given a number on the end if that address already exists).
Short description	The card text on the archive, the paragraph on the edition page, and the description Google shows.
The Publish button	The edition marked live, the home page hero replaced, the archive and sitemap updated, and view/download counters started at zero.

And this is what readers saw, one minute later

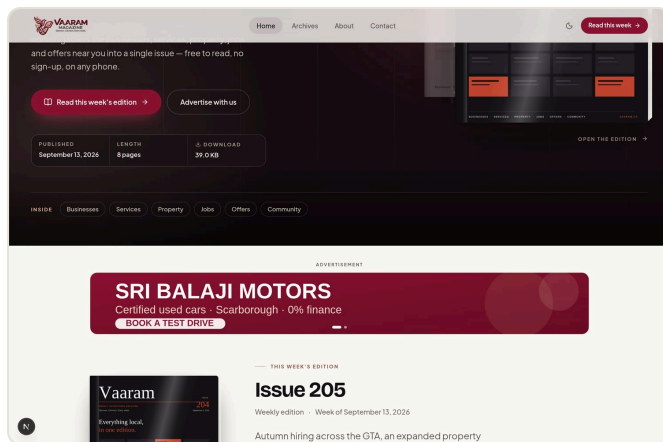


Figure 3.11 — the public home page: “This week's edition — Issue 205, Week of September 13, 2026”, with the description and the cover, exactly as typed.

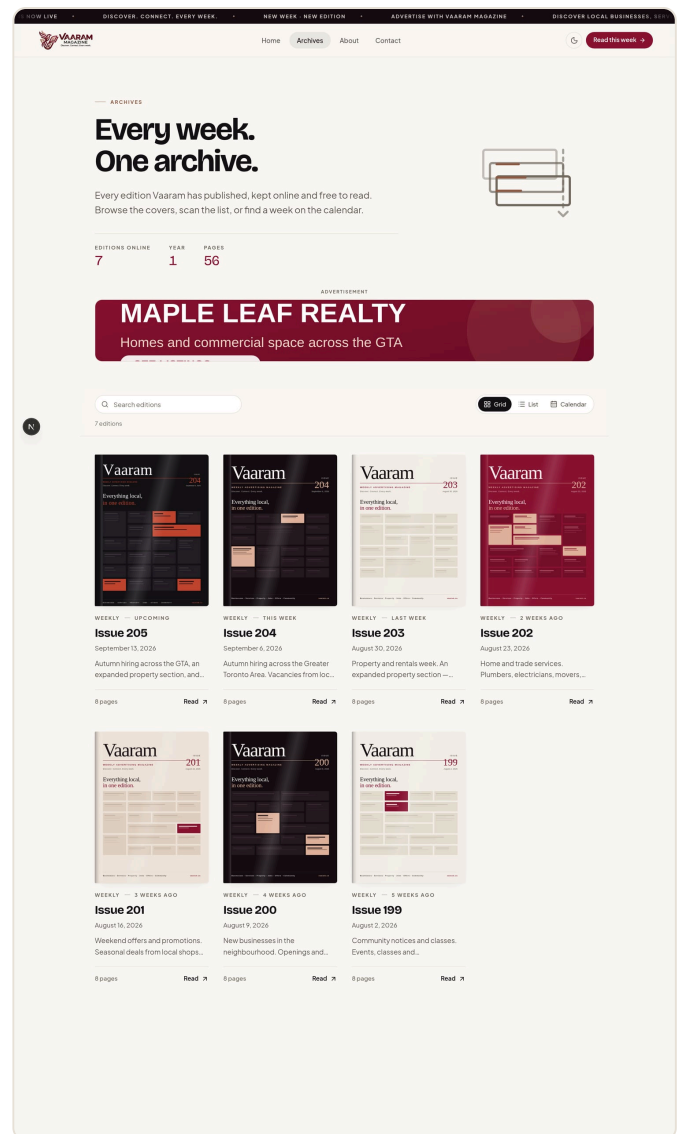


Figure 3.12 — the archive: Issue 205 now leads the grid, marked “This week”, with Issue 204 behind it.

The rule of thumb for the weekly job

Export the PDF → open Admin → Publish → drop the file → type the title and check the date → press Publish.
Everything else — cover, page count, file size, web address, sitemap, home page — is done for you.

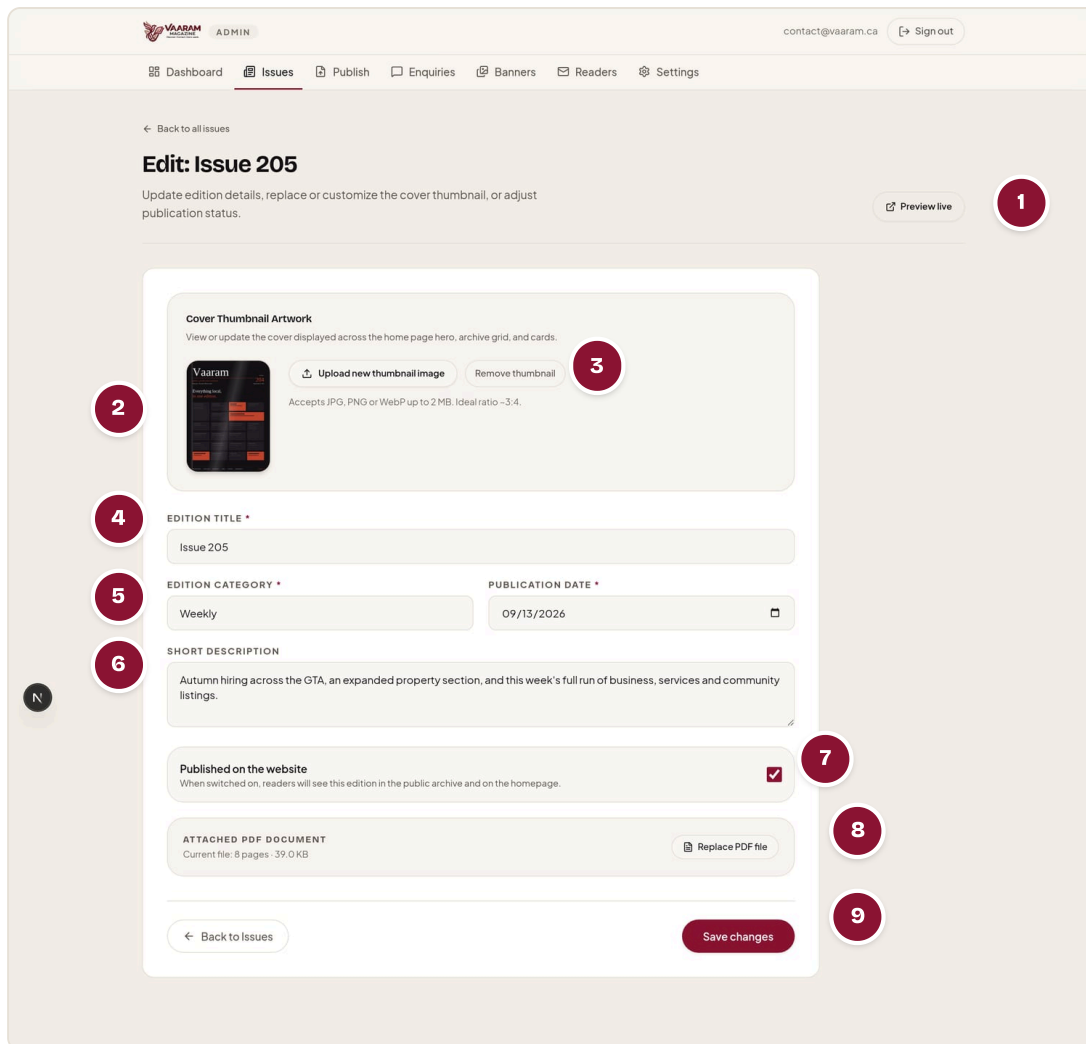
3.6 Draft or published — and how to change your mind

IF YOU PRESS ...	WHAT HAPPENS	UNDO
Publish edition	The file is uploaded and the edition becomes visible on the home page, the archive, the sitemap and to search engines within about a minute.	Issues → Unpublish
Save as draft	The file is uploaded and everything is saved, but nothing is visible to readers. Useful when the edition is finished on Friday and should not appear until Sunday.	Issues → Publish

A draft shows a grey **DRAFT** tag in the Issues list. Publishing it later is one click and needs no re-upload. There is no scheduling — the site does not publish automatically at a set time — so a Sunday edition prepared on Friday is saved as a draft and published by hand on the day.

3.7 Editing an edition after it is live

Everything about a published edition can be corrected without taking it down — including replacing the PDF itself if you spot a mistake after publishing.



1 **Preview live** — opens the reader's version of this edition in a new tab.

2 **The current cover.**

3 **Upload new thumbnail image** — replace the cover with your own artwork (JPG, PNG or WebP, up to 2 MB, roughly 3:4 shape). Beside it, **Remove thumbnail** falls back to the generated cover sheet.

4 **Edition title** — editable.

5 **Edition category** and **Publication date** — editable.

6 **Short description** — editable.

7 **Published on the website** — the same switch as Publish/Unpublish, in checkbox form.

8 **Attached PDF document** — shows the current file's pages and size, with **Replace PDF file** to swap in a corrected export. The page count and file size are re-read from the new file automatically.

9 **Save changes.**

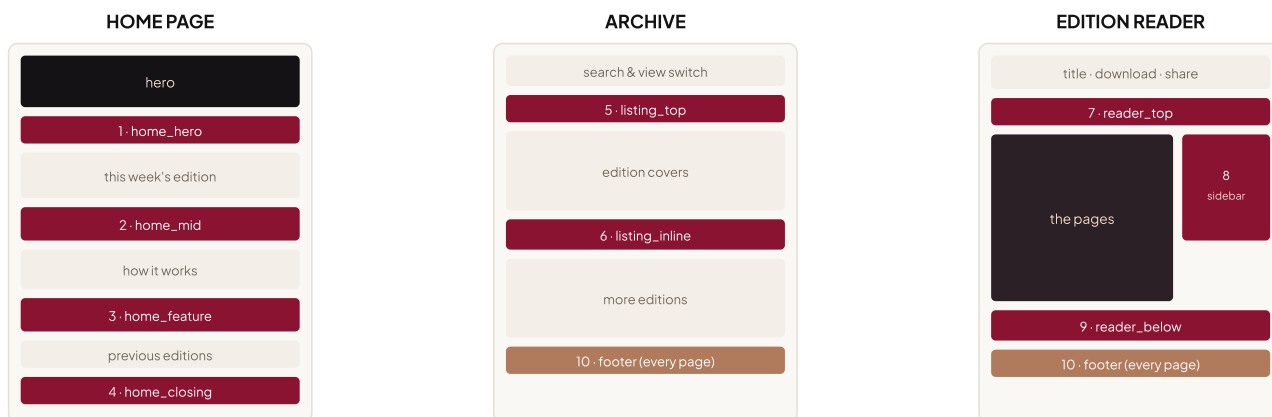
Figure 3.13 — Admin → Issues → Edit, for Issue 205.

One thing editing does not change

The edition's web address is fixed when it is first created. Renaming "Issue 205" to "Issue 205 — Property Special" changes the visible title everywhere, but the link stays `/archives/2026-09-13-weekly-issue-205`. That is deliberate: links already shared with advertisers or posted on social media keep working forever.

3.8 Banners — the ten paid places on the website

A banner is an advertisement on the **website**, which is a separate product from an advertisement **inside** the weekly PDF. Ten slots exist. Each one has a fixed shape, its own view and click counters, and can carry different artwork for desktop, tablet and phone.



Wine = a sellable placement. Gold = the footer slot, which appears on every page of the site.

The ten placements, with the exact artwork sizes the form asks for

#	PLACEMENT (AS IT APPEARS IN THE DROPDOWN)	DESKTOP 1024px +	TABLET 640–1023px	PHONE under 640px	WHERE IT LANDS
1	Home — under the hero	1600 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	The first thing after the headline. The most asked-for slot.
2	Home — mid page	1200 × 250	1200 × 300	800 × 500	Between “what Vaaram is” and “how it works”.
3	Home — feature block	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	The full-width panel halfway down the page.
4	Home — above the closing call	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	Last thing before “Get your business discovered”.
5	Archive — above the editions	1600 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	Top of the archive, above the covers.
6	Archive — between editions	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	Inside the grid, between rows of covers.
7	Reader — above the pages	1600 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	Directly above the magazine pages — seen by everyone who reads.
8	Reader — beside the pages	600 × 500	1000 × 600	1000 × 600	The upright panel in the reading sidebar. Stays in view while pages turn.
9	Reader — under the pages	1200 × 250	1200 × 300	800 × 500	Below the last page, before “more from the archive”.
10	Every page — above the footer	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400	Every page of the site. The highest impression count available.

Why three sizes, and what happens if you only supply one

A 1600 × 200 strip shrunk onto a phone would be 47 pixels tall and unreadable. So each slot asks for artwork drawn for each screen size. **Only the desktop file is required.** Anything you leave out falls back — phone falls back to tablet, tablet falls back to desktop — so a banner with one file still shows everywhere. The Banners list marks which sizes an advertiser actually supplied.

What happens after a banner goes live

BEHAVIOUR	DETAIL
Rotation	If more than one banner is booked in the same slot they rotate automatically, with small dots showing how many. One advertiser alone gets the slot to themselves.
Views counted	One “view” is counted each time the banner is actually shown to a reader.
Clicks counted	Counted when a reader clicks through to the advertiser's link, which opens in a new tab.
Click rate	Calculated for you and displayed on the banner card — the number to quote when the advertiser asks whether it is working.
Expiry	On the morning after the “stop showing on” date the banner simply stops appearing. It stays in your list, marked EXPIRED , with its final numbers intact.
Hide	Takes it off the site immediately but keeps everything, including the counters. The button becomes “Show”.
Delete	Removes the banner and its counters. Asks for confirmation first. The artwork stays in storage.
An empty slot	Never renders a blank box: it shows Vaaram's own “Want your advertisement in here?” panel, which links to your contact page — so an unsold slot is still selling.

3.9 Worked example: adding a digital banner

Sunrise Grocers, the advertiser who sent the first enquiry in Figure 2.24, has bought the home page slot under the hero until the end of the year. Here is exactly how that is set up — again, performed for real.

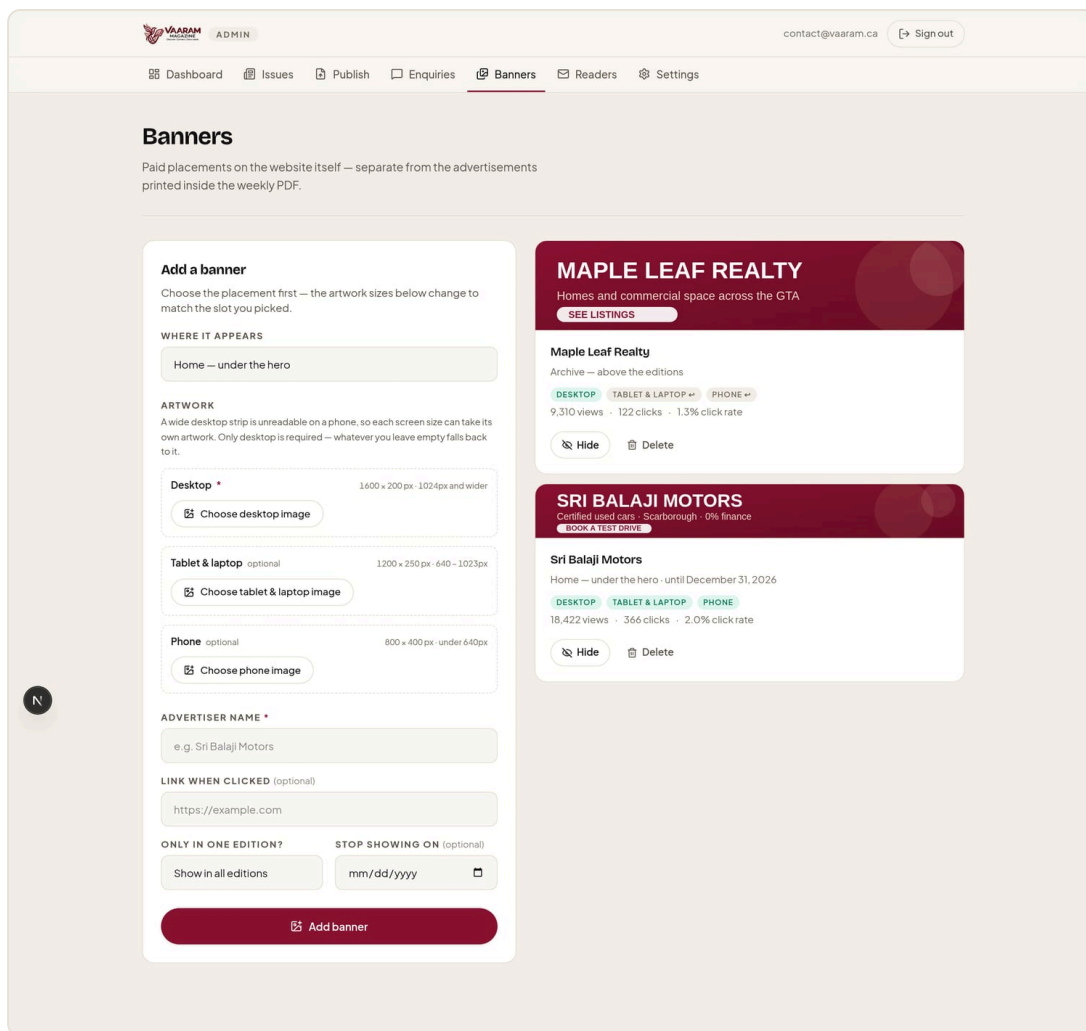


Figure 3.14 — Admin → Banners before adding the new advertiser. The form is always on the left, the banners already running are on the right.

ON THIS SCREEN	DETAIL
“Add a banner” form left column	Always in the same place, and it stays in view as you scroll the list.
“Where it appears”	Pick this <i>first</i> — the artwork sizes asked for underneath change to match the slot you choose.
The running banners right column	Newest first, each with its desktop artwork shown full width so you can see exactly what a reader sees.
The device tags	Green means that advertiser supplied their own artwork for that screen size; grey with an arrow means it falls back to the desktop file.
Views · clicks · click rate	Under each banner, with Hide and Delete beneath them.

EXACTLY WHAT WAS ENTERED

Where it appears	Home — under the hero
Desktop artwork *	upload-desktop.png · 1600 × 200 · 110.3 KB
Tablet & laptop artwork	upload-tablet.png · 1200 × 250 · 112.7 KB
Phone artwork	upload-mobile.png · 800 × 400 · 118.4 KB
Advertiser name *	Sunrise Grocers
Link when clicked	https://sunrisegrocers.example.ca
Only in one edition?	Show in all editions
Stop showing on	31 December 2026

Banners

Paid placements on the website itself — separate from the advertisements printed inside the weekly PDF.

Add a banner

Choose the placement first — the artwork sizes below change to match the slot you picked.

WHERE IT APPEARS

Home — under the hero

ARTWORK

A wide desktop strip is unreadable on a phone, so each screen size can take its own artwork. Only desktop is required — whatever you leave empty falls back to it.

Desktop * 1600 x 200 px · 1024px and wider
upload-desktop.png · 110.3 KB

Tablet & laptop optional 1200 x 250 px · 640 - 1023px
upload-tablet.png · 112.7 KB

Phone optional 800 x 400 px · under 640px
upload-mobile.png · 118.4 KB

ADVERTISER NAME *
Sunrise Grocers

LINK WHEN CLICKED (optional)
https://sunrisegrocers.example.ca

ONLY IN ONE EDITION? Show in all editions

STOP SHOWING ON (optional) 12/31/2026

Add banner

MAPLE LEAF REALTY
Homes and commercial space across the GTA
SEE LISTINGS

Maple Leaf Realty
Archive — above the editions
DESKTOP · TABLET & LAPTOP · PHONE
9,310 views · 122 clicks · 1.3% click rate
Hide Delete

SRI BALAJI MOTORS
Certified used cars · Scarborough · 0% finance
BOOK A TEST DRIVE

Sri Balaji Motors
Home — under the hero · until December 31, 2026
DESKTOP · TABLET & LAPTOP · PHONE
18,422 views · 366 clicks · 2.0% click rate
Hide Delete

- 1 **Desktop — required.** The size hint on the right (“1600 x 200 px · 1024px and wider”) changes with the placement you chose.
- 2 **Tablet & laptop — optional.**
- 3 **Phone — optional.** Each chosen file shows a small preview, its name and its size, with an X to swap it.
- 4 **Advertiser name — required.** This is how you will recognise the banner later; readers never see it.
- 5 **Link when clicked — optional.** Must start with `http://` or `https://`. Anything else is rejected and stored as no link, which is a deliberate safety rule.
- 6 **Only in one edition?** “Show in all editions” is normal. The alternative restricts a banner to a single edition type.
- 7 **Stop showing on — optional.** The banner disappears by itself on this date. Leave empty to run until you hide it.
- 8 **Add banner.** Each supplied file uploads in turn with its own progress bar.

Figure 3.15 — the completed banner form, with artwork chosen for all three screen sizes.

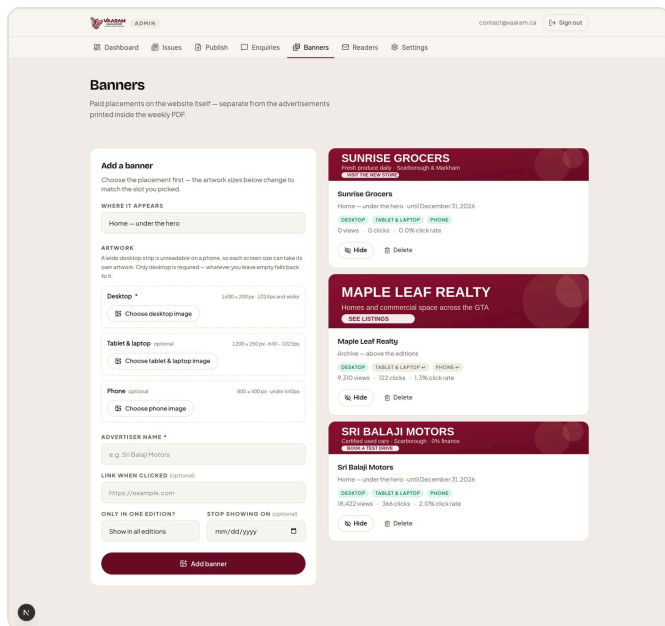


Figure 3.16 — saved. Sunrise Grocers is now at the top of the list with all three device tags green, 0 views and 0 clicks, and an expiry of 31 December 2026.

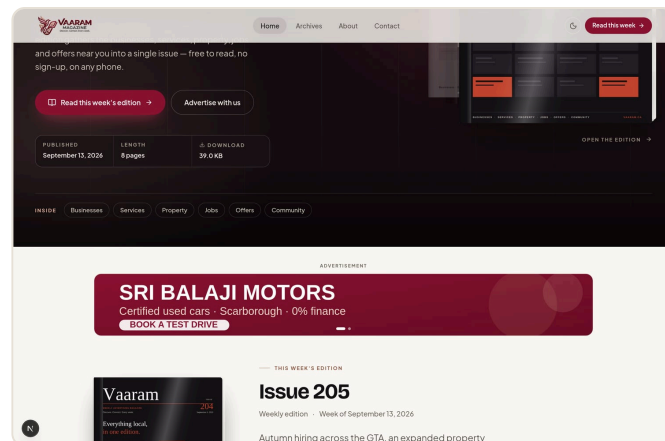


Figure 3.17 — and live on the public home page, under the hero, marked “ADVERTISEMENT”. Two banners are booked in this slot, so they rotate — note the two dots in the corner.

Keep banner artwork small

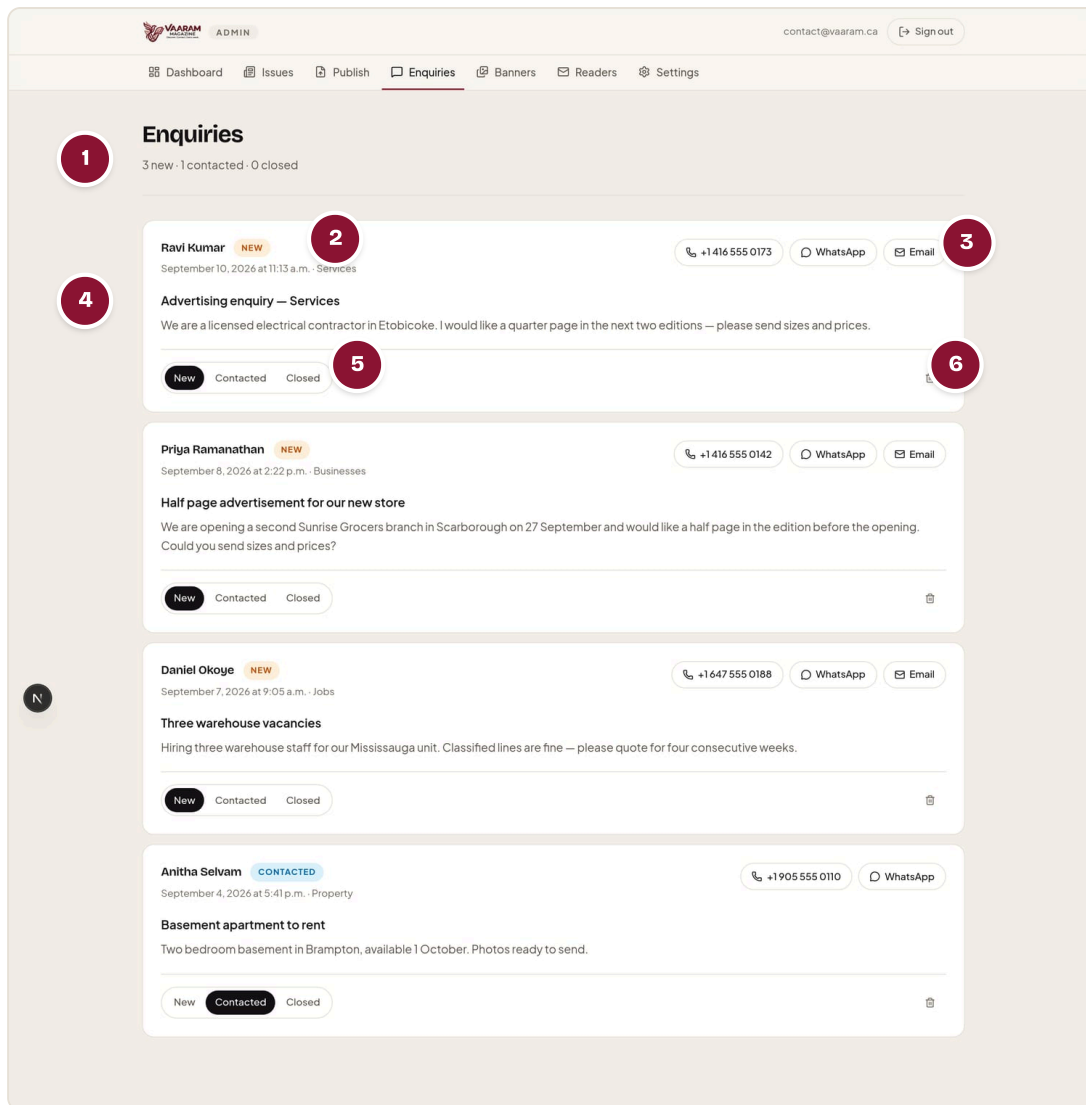
Every visitor downloads banner artwork exactly as you upload it — there is no automatic compression. The form refuses anything over **2 MB**, but aim for under **200 KB**. Export as JPG for photographs, PNG for flat colour and text, and if your design tool offers WebP, use it. A heavy banner slows every page it appears on and eats the bandwidth allowance described in Part 4.

One small inconsistency to be aware of

The empty-slot placeholder for “Home — feature block” reads “best at 1200 × 500 px”, while the upload form for that slot asks for 1200 × 200. The form is the one to follow. We will align the placeholder wording in the next update; it affects nothing else.

3.10 Enquiries — reading and answering them

Every message from the contact form lands here, newest first, with the sender's own contact details turned into buttons. This is the screen to open first thing each morning.



- 1 **The running total** — “3 new · 1 contacted · 0 closed”. Your workload in one line.
- 2 **Name, status tag and the exact time it arrived**, followed by the category they picked.
- 3 **Three reply buttons**. The phone number dials on a mobile; WhatsApp opens a chat with that number; Email opens your mail app. The email button only appears if they gave an address — the phone number is always there because it is required.
- 4 **Subject and the full message**, never truncated.
- 5 **New / Contacted / Closed**. Click one to move the enquiry along. The change is instant and the counts at the top update.
- 6 **The bin icon** deletes the enquiry, after asking you to confirm.

Figure 3.18 — Enquiries. The top message is the one submitted through the public form in Figure 2.22, arriving here seconds later.

The three statuses, and how to use them

STATUS	MEANING
NEW	Nobody has replied. This is the number shown on the dashboard as your to-do count.
CONTACTED	You have called, messaged or emailed them. Still open — waiting on artwork, a decision or a payment.
CLOSED	Finished, one way or the other. It stays in the list as a record.

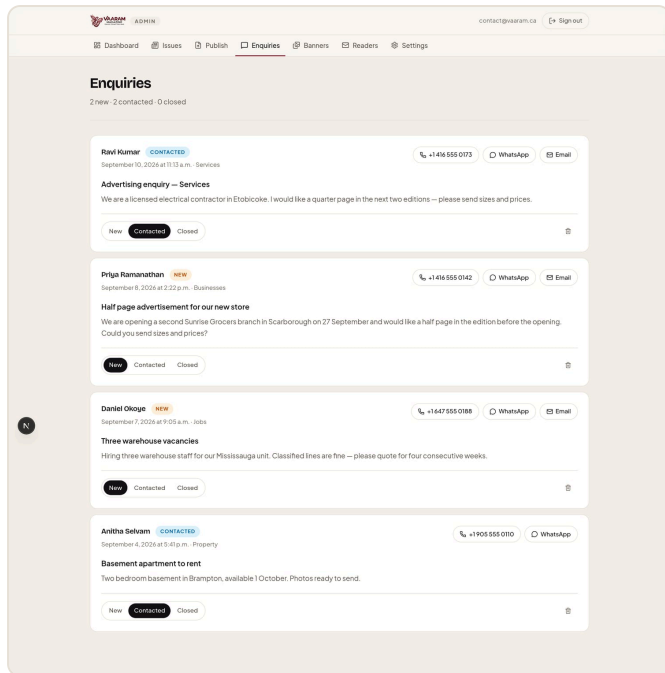


Figure 3.19 — the same enquiry after pressing **Contacted**: the tag turns blue and the counter at the top of the page drops from 3 new to 2.

A suggested weekly routine

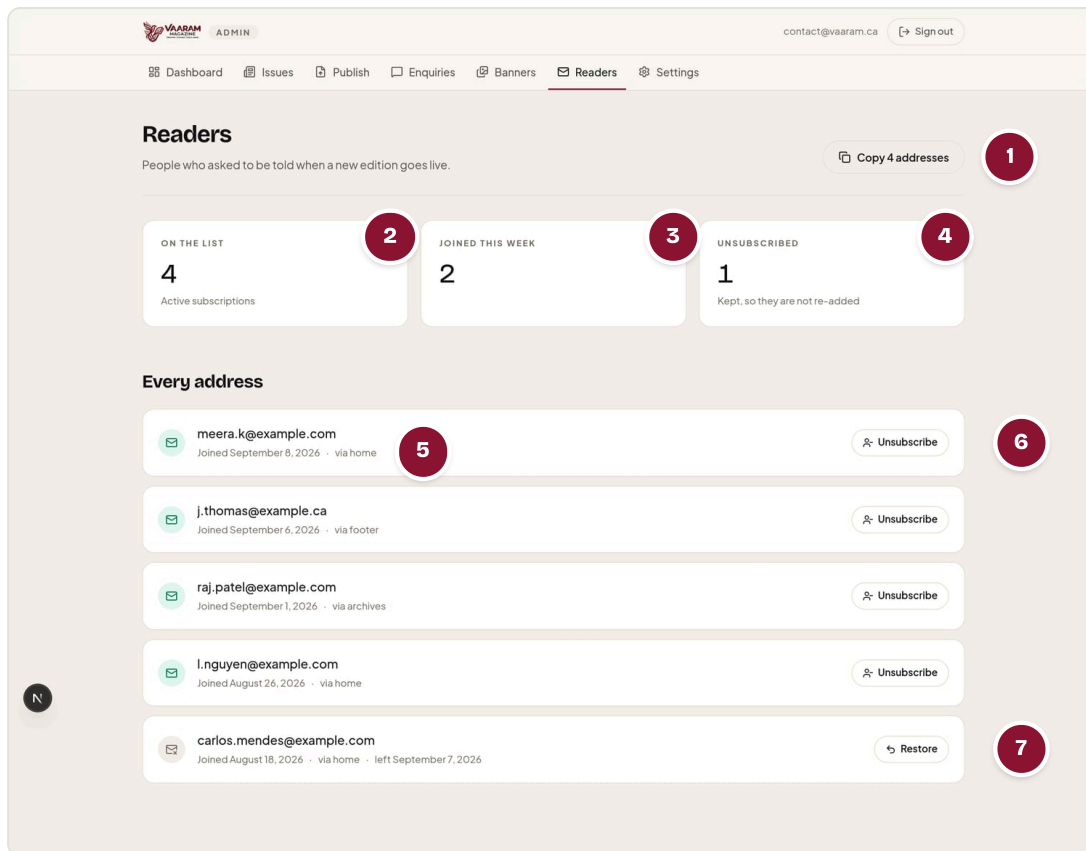
- Open Enquiries. Work top-down through everything tagged **New**.
- Call from the button rather than copying the number — it dials, and you cannot mistype it.
- Mark **Contacted** as soon as you have spoken to them, even if nothing is booked yet.
- Mark **Closed** when the advertisement runs, or when they say no.
- Delete only genuine spam. Everything else is a record of who approached you and when.

If nothing is here

An empty screen says so plainly. Messages appear the moment someone uses the form — there is nothing to refresh or fetch.

3.11 Readers — the newsletter list

The site collects email addresses from three places — the home page band, the archive page and the footer of every page. Each address is recorded with where it came from, so the list can always be traced back.



- 1 **Copy 4 addresses.** One click puts every *active* address on your clipboard, comma-separated, ready to paste into whichever mail tool you use.
- 2 **On the list** — active subscriptions.
- 3 **Joined this week** — growth at a glance.
- 4 **Unsubscribed** — kept on purpose, so that a future import cannot re-add somebody who asked to leave.
- 5 **Joined date and source** — “via home”, “via footer”, “via archives”.
- 6 **Unsubscribe** — removes them from the active list if they ask you directly.
- 7 **Restore** — puts a lapsed reader back, if they ask to return.

Figure 3.20 — Admin → Readers.

What the newsletter feature is — and what it is not

BUILT AND WORKING	NOT BUILT, ON PURPOSE
• Sign-up boxes on the home page, the archive and every footer • Addresses validated and stored in lower case • Duplicates handled — signing up twice simply reactivates the same entry • Source recorded for every address • Spam trap and a five-per-ten-minutes limit • A full list you own, with unsubscribe and restore • One-click copy of every active address	A “send the newsletter” button. Sending bulk email properly needs three things this website should not own: a mail provider account, a verified sending domain (so Gmail does not mark you as spam), and a working one-click unsubscribe link in every message, which is a legal requirement under Canada's anti-spam law. A half-built send button would put your domain's email reputation at risk on the first Sunday. What is built instead is complete ownership of the list, and a copy button that takes one second.

How to actually send this week's email, today

- 1 Publish the edition first**
— you need its link.
- 2 Open Admin → Readers and press “Copy N addresses”**
- 3 Paste them into the BCC field**
of a normal email from `contact@vaaram.ca`, with yourself in the To field. BCC matters: it stops every reader seeing every other reader's address.
- 4 Write four lines and one link**

Subject: Vaaram Magazine — Issue 205 is out

This week's edition is live and free to read.

Autumn hiring across the GTA, an expanded property section, and the full run of business, services and community listings.

Read Issue 205 → <https://vaaram.ca/archives/2026-09-13-weekly-issue-205>

You are receiving this because you asked to be told when a new edition goes live.

To stop, reply with the word STOP and we will remove you.

When someone replies STOP

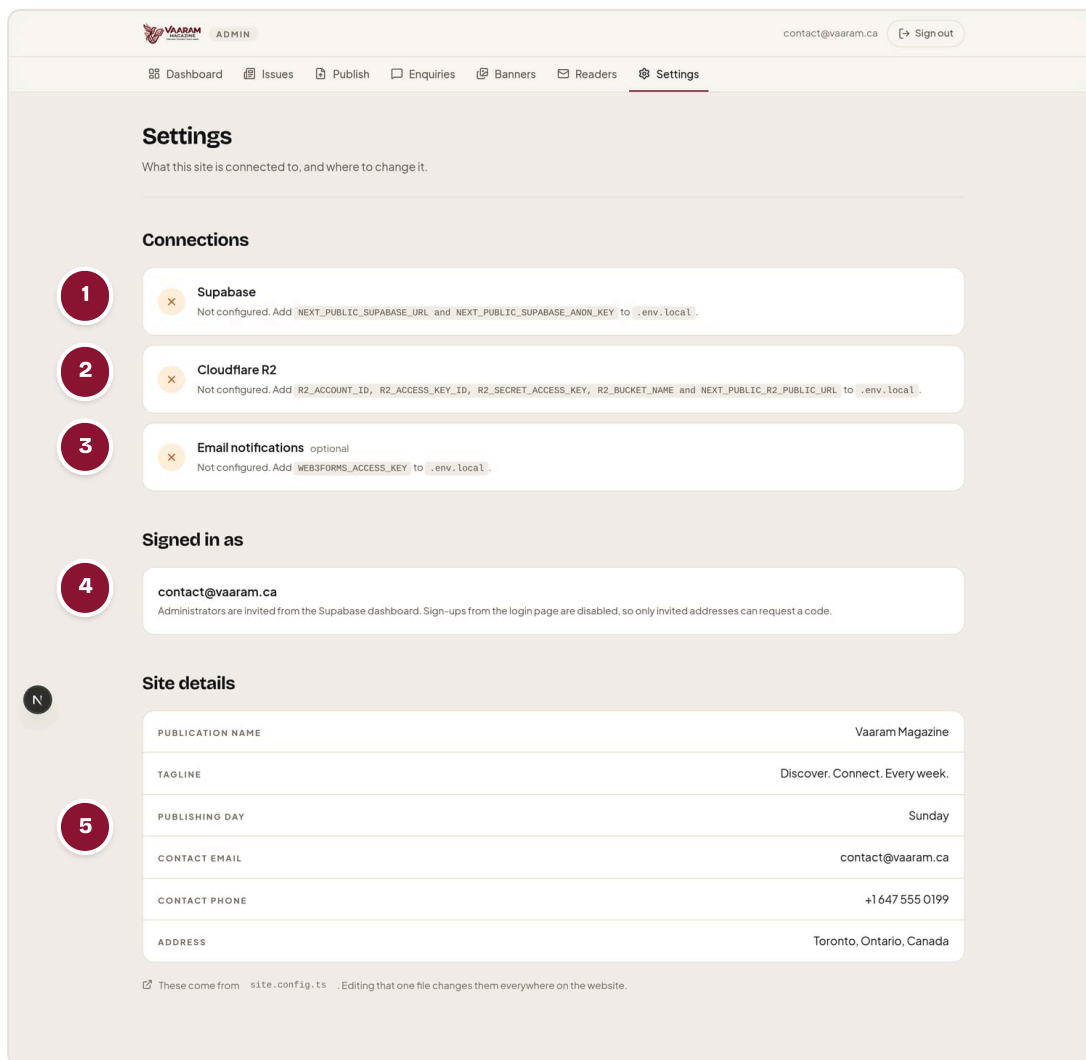
, open Admin → Readers, find them, press **Unsubscribe**. Do it the same day — it is the law, and it takes five seconds.

When the list passes about 200 readers

Move to a proper mail tool — Brevo, Mailchimp or MailerLite all have free tiers that cover a weekly send to a few thousand people. They add a real unsubscribe link, handle bounces, and tell you how many people opened the email. Paste the copied addresses in once to import, then paste the new ones each week. If you would like the site to talk to that tool directly, so a new sign-up appears in it automatically and the email sends itself the moment you publish, that is a well-defined piece of follow-on work — see Part 5.

3.12 Settings

Settings is deliberately read-only. It answers one question: what is this website connected to, and what is still missing? Nothing here can be edited from the browser, because these are credentials and they belong in the host's own control panel.



1 Supabase — the database and your login. Must be green before launch.

2 Cloudflare R2 — file storage with free downloads. Optional, but see Part 4 for why it matters.

3 Email notifications — optional; sends a copy of each enquiry to your inbox.

4 Signed in as — the administrator address currently in use, and a reminder that new administrators are invited from the Supabase dashboard.

5 Site details — the publication name, tagline, publishing day, contact email, phone and address, exactly as they appear across the public site. To change any of them, we edit one configuration file and redeploy — a five-minute job.

Figure 3.21 — Settings, captured on the demonstration copy, which has no credentials connected. **On your live site all three rows will show a green tick.** An amber cross here means that service is not connected yet and names the exact setting that is missing.

Settings also warns you about the database

If the database is ever missing a table — for instance after we ship an update that adds a new feature — a yellow banner appears at the top of this page naming the table and telling you what to run. It is the site's own self-check.

3.13 Every field, every limit

Publish an edition

FIELD	REQUIRED	ACCEPTS	RULES AND NOTES
Edition PDF	YES	PDF only	Maximum 50 MB . Anything else is refused before the upload starts, with the file's size named in the message. Aim for under 25 MB.
Cover thumbnail	NO	JPG, PNG, WebP	Maximum 2 MB . If left empty, page 1 of the PDF is used automatically.
Edition title	YES	Text	Up to 200 characters. Used in the title, the archive card, the browser tab and the web address.
Edition	YES	Dropdown	Currently one option, "Weekly". Additional editions are a configuration change.
Publication date	YES	Date	Defaults to today. Sets "Week of..." , the archive order and the calendar position.
Short description	NO	Text	Up to 500 characters. Shown on the card, on the edition page, and by Google.

Add a banner

FIELD	REQUIRED	ACCEPTS	RULES AND NOTES
Where it appears	YES	Dropdown of 10	Choose first — it sets the artwork sizes asked for below.
Desktop artwork	YES	JPG, PNG, WebP	Maximum 2 MB . This is the fallback for every other screen size.
Tablet artwork	NO	JPG, PNG, WebP	Maximum 2 MB. Falls back to desktop.
Phone artwork	NO	JPG, PNG, WebP	Maximum 2 MB. Falls back to tablet, then desktop.
Advertiser name	YES	Text	Up to 160 characters. Internal only — readers never see it.
Link when clicked	NO	Web address	Must begin <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code> . Anything else is silently stored as "no link", which protects readers from a malicious address.
Only in one edition?	NO	Dropdown	Default is every edition.
Stop showing on	NO	Date	The banner hides itself after this date and is tagged EXPIRED.

What a visitor can submit

FIELD	REQUIRED	LIMIT	NOTES
Contact — name	YES	120 characters	Six submissions per ten minutes from one visitor. A hidden trap field catches robots.
Contact — phone	YES	30 characters	
Contact — email	NO	160 characters	
Contact — category	NO	Your six categories	
Contact — message	YES	4,000 characters	
Newsletter — email	YES	190 characters	Five submissions per ten minutes. Stored lower case; a repeat sign-up reactivates rather than duplicates.

3.14 Messages you may see, and what they mean

MESSAGE	WHAT TO DO
"That is not a PDF. Please choose the print-ready PDF of the edition."	A different file type was picked — often a Word or InDesign file. Export to PDF first.
"That PDF is 62.4 MB. The limit is 50 MB — export it at a lower image quality and try again."	Re-export with images at 150 dpi, or run it through a PDF compressor. This also makes the edition faster for readers.
"Cover image is 3.1 MB. Maximum size is 2 MB."	Only for custom cover artwork. Save it smaller, or skip it and let page 1 be the cover.
"Banner images must be JPG, PNG or WebP."	A PDF, SVG or HEIC file was chosen. Export as JPG or PNG.
"Desktop artwork is required — it is what every other size falls back to."	Add at least the desktop file before saving the banner.
"Upload failed to reach storage. If you just set up Cloudflare R2, check the bucket's CORS rules allow PUT from this site."	A storage configuration problem, not something you did wrong. Send us this message and we will fix the bucket rules.
"You need to sign in first."	The session expired — usually after a long time on the same tab. Sign in again; nothing is lost except the form you were filling in.
"Incorrect email or password. Please try again."	Check the address first. If the password is genuinely lost, use "Sign in with email verification code instead".
"Too many requests. Wait a minute before trying again."	Too many login codes requested in a short time. Wait sixty seconds.
"We could not save that. Please call us on ..." (seen by a visitor)	The database was unreachable when someone sent the contact form. Rare; tell us if a visitor reports it.
A yellow "The database is out of date" banner in Settings	An update added a table that has not been created yet. Send us a screenshot; it is a one-minute fix.

04

Free tiers, egress and what it costs

The single most important commercial decision about this website, explained in full. Read 4.3 and 4.5 even if you skip everything else.

- 4.1 What “egress” means, in one page
- 4.2 The actual free allowances today
- 4.3 The arithmetic: how many readers before you hit a ceiling
- 4.4 What happens when a limit is reached
- 4.5 Six ways to remove the limit — ranked

4.1 What “egress” means, in one page

Egress is simply **data leaving the server** — every megabyte sent to a reader. It is the one number that a magazine website has to watch, because a magazine is a big file and every reader takes a whole copy.



Two different numbers get confused, so to be clear about which is which:

NUMBER	WHAT IT MEASURES	HOW FAST IT GROWS FOR VAARAM
Storage	How many megabytes you are keeping on the server, in total, forever.	Slowly — one edition a week.
Egress (bandwidth)	How many megabytes were sent out to readers this month.	Fast. It is the file size multiplied by the number of people who read it.

Why this matters more for you than for most websites

An ordinary small business website sends perhaps 2 MB per visitor. Vaaram sends the whole magazine — commonly 10 to 30 MB. A single popular edition can therefore use more bandwidth in a week than a normal site uses in a year. Choosing the right storage provider is not a technical detail here; it is the difference between \$0 a month and an unpleasant surprise.

4.2 The actual free allowances today

Figures as published by each provider in September 2026. Providers change these; check their pricing page before relying on a number.

SERVICE	FREE STORAGE	FREE EGRESS / MONTH	WHAT IT COSTS TO GO BEYOND
Supabase database + login, and file storage if R2 is not connected	1 GB of files 500 MB of database	5 GB	Pro plan about US\$25/month — 100 GB storage and 250 GB egress, then roughly US\$0.09 per extra GB.
Cloudflare R2 file storage, recommended	10 GB of files	Unlimited — R2 never charges for downloads	Storage beyond 10 GB is about US\$0.015 per GB per month. 100 GB of editions ≈ US\$1.35/month.
Vercel (Hobby) running the website itself	n/a	100 GB pages, not PDFs	Pro is US\$20/month. Note: Vercel's free Hobby plan is for non-commercial projects — a magazine selling advertising should be on Pro, or hosted elsewhere. See 5.2.
Cloudflare Pages / Workers alternative host	n/a	No bandwidth charge	Free tier allows 100,000 requests per day; commercial use is permitted.
Web3Forms emails you a copy of each enquiry	n/a	250 submissions/month free	Paid tiers from about US\$8/month. Enquiries are stored in your dashboard either way.

4.3 The arithmetic: how many readers before you hit a ceiling

Assume a typical edition of **15 MB**, and that each person who reads or downloads it transfers roughly one full copy.

Reading the edition — the egress question

IF EACH WEEK YOU GET ...	PER MONTH	EGRESS USED	ON SUPABASE FREE (5 GB)	ON R2
25 readers	108	1.6 GB	COMFORTABLE	FREE
75 readers	323	4.7 GB	AT THE EDGE	FREE
150 readers	645	9.5 GB	Over by 4.5 GB	FREE
500 readers	2,150	31.5 GB	Over by 26 GB	FREE
2,000 readers	8,600	126 GB	Needs the paid plan	FREE

The headline number

On Supabase's free storage, roughly **340 opened editions a month** — about **80 readers a week** — uses the whole free egress allowance. For a magazine whose whole purpose is to be read widely, that ceiling is low. On Cloudflare R2 the same traffic, and a hundred times that traffic, costs nothing at all.

Keeping the editions — the storage question

EDITION SIZE	EDITIONS IN SUPABASE'S 1 GB	EDITIONS IN R2'S 10 GB	IN YEARS OF WEEKLY PUBLISHING
8 MB (lean export)	128	1,280	2.4 years / 24 years
15 MB (typical)	68	683	1.3 years / 13 years
30 MB (image-heavy)	34	341	8 months / 6.5 years

Storage is the slow problem; egress is the fast one. Even at 30 MB an edition, R2's free storage lasts more than six years — and after that, keeping *ten years* of editions costs about a dollar a month.

4.4 What happens when a limit is reached

LIMIT	WHAT READERS EXPERIENCE	WHAT YOU DO
Supabase egress used up	Downloads and the reader slow down and can start failing. The rest of the site keeps working — only the files are affected.	Connect R2 (below). It takes about half an hour and fixes it permanently.
Supabase storage full	Publishing a new edition fails at the upload step with a storage error. Existing editions keep working.	Connect R2, or upgrade the Supabase plan.
Database rows	Not a practical concern — enquiries, subscribers and editions are tiny text records. 500 MB is many years of them.	Nothing.
Host bandwidth	Only the pages themselves count here, roughly 1–2 MB per visit, so 100 GB is tens of thousands of visits a month.	Nothing, until the magazine is very large.
Web3Forms free submissions	You stop getting the email copy of enquiries.	Nothing urgent — every enquiry is still saved and visible in the dashboard.
Supabase project idle	A free Supabase project pauses after a week with no activity, and the site would show no editions until it is resumed.	Publishing weekly prevents this. It is another reason to be on a paid plan eventually.

4.5 Six ways to remove the limit — ranked

1 Connect Cloudflare R2 — do this before launch

A free Cloudflare account, one bucket, five settings pasted into the host's control panel. R2 charges **nothing for downloads, ever**, which removes the egress ceiling completely and permanently. The website already supports it: the code checks for the R2 settings and uses them if present, and falls back to Supabase Storage if not — so nothing needs rebuilding and nothing needs re-uploading. Old editions keep their existing links; new ones simply go to the new home.

Effort: about 30 minutes. Cost: \$0 up to 10 GB, then roughly \$0.015 per GB per month. One extra step is required — the bucket must be told to accept uploads from `vaaram.ca`. The rule file is already prepared in the project.

2 Export a leaner PDF

Halving the file size doubles every number in Part 4.3 at no cost. In InDesign or Illustrator, export with images downsampled to 150 dpi and JPEG quality “medium” — perfectly sharp on a screen, and typically a third of the size. Keep the print-quality file for the printer; publish the lighter one.

3 Serve the files through Cloudflare's cache

Put the storage bucket behind a Cloudflare custom domain, for example `media.vaaram.ca`. Popular editions are then served from Cloudflare's edge servers, so the second and subsequent readers of a given file never touch your storage at all. Free, and it also makes downloads noticeably faster for readers.

- 4 Choose the right host for a commercial site**

Either Vercel Pro (US\$20/month, the simplest, best-supported option for this kind of site) or Cloudflare Workers, which permits commercial use on its free tier and has no bandwidth charge. We will recommend one at deployment time — see 5.2.
- 5 Upgrade Supabase when the magazine grows**

US\$25/month buys 100 GB of storage, 250 GB of egress, daily backups and no idle pausing. Worth doing when the publication is established, whether or not R2 is used, because it also removes the pause risk on the database.
- 6 Later: publish a light web edition and a full download**

A screen-optimised PDF for reading in the browser and the full-quality file behind the Download button. Most readers never download, so this cuts bandwidth sharply. It needs a small addition to the publish screen — a second upload slot — and is the natural next feature if the magazine gets big.

Our recommendation, in one line

Connect Cloudflare R2 before launch and keep editions under about 15 MB. With those two things done, the running cost of this website is the domain renewal and — if you choose Vercel Pro — US\$20 a month. Nothing else.

05

What is left, and what we need from you

The website is finished software sitting on our machines. Everything below is about getting it onto your domain, under your accounts, with your mailbox working.

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| 5.1 | The launch checklist |
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| 5.2 | Hosting the website |
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| 5.3 | The domain at GoDaddy — and the access we need |
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- | | |
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| 5.4 | The <code>contact@vaaram.ca</code> mailbox — currently unreachable |
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| 5.5 | Database, storage and email keys |
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| 5.6 | Details still marked as placeholders |
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- | | |
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| 5.7 | One page to send back to us |
|-----|-----------------------------|
-

5.1 The launch checklist

#	TASK	WHO	EFFORT	BLOCKED BY
1	Create the Supabase project and run the database setup	Us	30 min	Nothing
2	Create your administrator account and set the password	Us	5 min	Task 1
3	Create the Cloudflare R2 bucket and connect it	Us	30 min	Nothing
4	Confirm the hosting plan and put the site into production the Vercel project already exists and builds	Us	1 hour	Your decision on 5.2
5	Point vaaram.ca at the site	Us, with your access	15 min + up to 24h wait	GoDaddy access — 5.3
6	Get the contact@vaaram.ca mailbox working	You, or us with access	30 min	Mailbox decision — 5.4
7	Connect the enquiry email notifications	Us	10 min	Task 6
8	Replace the placeholder phone number and address	You give, we apply	10 min	Your details — 5.6
9	Add your social media links, if any	You give, we apply	5 min	Your details
10	Publish the first real edition together, on a call	Both	30 min	Tasks 1–5
11	Read and approve the Privacy and Terms pages	You	20 min	Nothing
12	Submit the site to Google Search Console	Us	15 min	Task 5

Total

About one working day of our time, spread across two calendar days because DNS changes need time to spread. Three of the twelve tasks are waiting on something only you can give us — items 5, 6 and 8.

5.2 Hosting the website

Good news — this is further along than the rest of the list

A Vercel project (`vaaram-magazine`) is already connected to the code repository, and it builds and deploys the site successfully on every change — the most recent build, made while this document was being finished, completed without error. So the website already runs on a real server today. What is left is a decision about which plan it runs on, pasting in the live database and storage credentials, and pointing the domain at it.

Important: GoDaddy web hosting cannot run this website

If you have — or are offered — a GoDaddy “web hosting” or “cPanel” plan, it will not work here. Those plans serve fixed HTML files and PHP. This site is a Next.js application: it builds each page as it is requested, checks who is signed in, and talks to the database on the server side. It needs a host built for that. **Keep the domain at GoDaddy — that part is perfect — and point it at a host that can run the application.**

OPTION	COST	ASSESSMENT
Vercel Pro recommended	US\$20/month	Built by the same team as the framework this site uses; everything works with no adaptation. Commercial use is permitted on Pro. One-click rollback if an update ever misbehaves, and a preview link for every change before it goes live. This is what we would choose.
Cloudflare Workers	Free tier, commercial use allowed	Genuinely free at your traffic level, and it pairs naturally with R2 storage. Needs a small adapter and slightly more care at each update. A good choice if keeping monthly cost at zero matters more than convenience.
Netlify	Free / US\$19 per member	Works well, widely used, a middle option between the two above.
Vercel Hobby	Free	Technically fine and the fastest way to see the site live — but Vercel's own terms restrict the Hobby plan to non-commercial projects, and Vaaram sells advertising. Acceptable for a few days of testing, not as the permanent home.

What we need from you: a decision between Vercel Pro and Cloudflare Workers, and — whichever you choose — an account created in *your* name with us added as a member. The site should belong to you, not to your developer.

5.3 The domain at GoDaddy — and the access we need

`vaaram.ca` is registered at GoDaddy. To make it show this website, two small DNS records have to be changed in that account. We cannot do it without access, and we would rather you did not email us your password.

The right way: add us as a delegate (about two minutes)

GoDaddy has a built-in feature for exactly this. It does not share your password, it can be limited to domains only, and you can revoke it in one click when the work is done.

1 Sign in to GoDaddy

with the account that owns vaaram.ca.

2 Open Account Settings → Delegate Access

The direct address is `account.godaddy.com/access`.

3 Under “People who can access my account”, choose “Invite to access”

4 Enter these details

Name	Nivas
Email	nivassri183@gmail.com
Access level	Products, Domains & Purchase — or the narrower “Products & Domains” if offered

5 Press Invite

We receive an email, accept it, make the two DNS changes, and tell you when it is done. You then remove the delegate access from the same screen whenever you wish.

The alternative: you make the changes yourself

Perfectly reasonable, and we will be on a call while you do it. In GoDaddy: **My Products** → **Domains** → **vaaram.ca** → **DNS** → **Manage Zones**, then set exactly the two records the host displays. They are typically:

TYPE	NAME	VALUE	PURPOSE
A	@	76.76.21.21	Makes <code>vaaram.ca</code> load the site
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com	Makes <code>www.vaaram.ca</code> load the site

Use the values your host shows you, not the ones printed here

The two rows above are what Vercel uses today and are given so the shape of the task is clear. Hosts occasionally change them, and Cloudflare's values are different again. At the moment of setup the host displays the exact records — copy them from there. Changes usually take effect within an hour, and can take up to 24 hours to reach everyone.

Please do not change the nameservers

Only the two records above need to change. Leave the nameservers pointing at GoDaddy unless we agree otherwise in advance — moving them also moves your email routing, and would take the mailbox offline.

5.4 The contact@vaaram.ca mailbox — currently unreachable

Stating this plainly

The address **contact@vaaram.ca** appears on the contact page, in the footer of every page, in the site's structured data and as the administrator sign-in address. **We have no access to that inbox and cannot confirm it exists.** Nothing sent to it can be read or answered by us, and we cannot test anything that depends on receiving mail there.

What is affected until it works

AFFECTED	CONSEQUENCE
Replies from readers and advertisers	Anyone who emails the address instead of using the form gets no answer — or a bounce.
“Email me a code” sign-in	Cannot be used. The password method still works, so the dashboard is fully usable meanwhile.
Enquiry notifications	Cannot be switched on. Enquiries are still saved and visible in the dashboard.
The weekly newsletter	Should be sent from this address to look legitimate and avoid spam folders.
Password resets	A lost administrator password is recovered by email to this address.

The options, cheapest first

OPTION	COST	NOTES
Email forwarding contact@vaaram.ca → an existing Gmail	Usually free	Quickest possible fix. You receive mail, but replies come <i>from</i> the Gmail address unless it is configured to send as contact@vaaram.ca. Fine as a stop-gap.
Zoho Mail free plan	Free for one mailbox	A real mailbox on your own domain at no cost. Needs a few DNS records adding at GoDaddy.
GoDaddy Professional Email	≈ CA\$3–7 / month	Sold in the same account as the domain, so it configures itself. The path of least resistance.
Google Workspace	≈ CA\$8+ / month	Gmail on your own domain, with Drive and Calendar. The best experience if the publication will have more than one person.

What we need from you — pick one

- **The mailbox already exists:** send us its sign-in details, *or* set a forward from contact@vaaram.ca to `nivassri183@gmail.com` for the launch period so we can complete testing.
- **The mailbox does not exist yet:** tell us which of the four options above you prefer. With GoDaddy delegate access (5.3) we can set it up for you.

→ **You would rather use a different address entirely** (for example a Gmail address you already read): tell us, and we will change it everywhere on the site in ten minutes.

5.5 Database, storage and email keys

These are ours to do, but they should live in accounts you own, so that the website is never hostage to a developer's login. We will create each one, hand you the credentials, and add ourselves as a collaborator.

ACCOUNT	COST	WHAT IT IS FOR
Supabase	Free to start	The database and your administrator login. Required before the site can go live with real content.
Cloudflare	Free	The R2 bucket for PDFs and images — the fix for the egress ceiling in Part 4.
Web3Forms	Free	Optional. Emails you a copy of each enquiry as it arrives.
The host	See 5.2	Runs the website itself.

5.6 Details still marked as placeholders

Three details on the live site are deliberately fake, so that nothing incorrect is published by accident. They are marked as placeholders in the code and need your real values.

DETAIL	CURRENTLY SHOWS	WHERE IT APPEARS
Phone number	+1 647 555 0199 555 numbers are reserved and can never connect	Contact page, footer of every page, error messages, structured data
WhatsApp number	16475550199	The WhatsApp button on the contact page
Street address	Toronto, Ontario, Canada	Contact page, footer
Social media links	Empty — the icons are hidden	Footer. Give us Facebook, Instagram or YouTube addresses and they appear.
Office hours	Monday - Saturday, 9:00 AM - 6:00 PM ET	Contact page. Correct this if it is wrong.

5.7 One page to send back to us

Fill this in and reply — it unblocks everything.

Contact details for the website	
Phone number to publish	
WhatsApp number (if different)	
Address to publish	
Office hours	
Facebook / Instagram / YouTube	
Legal business name for Terms	

Access we need	
GoDaddy delegate access invite nivassri183@gmail.com	Sent ☐ I will do the DNS myself on a call ☐
contact@vaaram.ca mailbox	Already exists, details attached ☐ Please set one up — preferred option: _____ ☐ Use a different address instead: _____ ☐
Hosting choice	Vercel Pro, US\$20/month ☐ Cloudflare Workers, free ☐ You decide for me ☐
Who should own the accounts	Created in my name, developer added as collaborator ☐

Approvals	
Privacy page	Approved ☐ Changes needed: _____
Terms page	Approved ☐ Changes needed: _____
Administrator password	Keep as issued ☐ Change at launch to one I choose ☐
Target launch date	

A-D

Appendices

Reference material. Nothing here is needed to run the magazine week to week — it is for whoever maintains the site, including any future developer.

A	Environment variables in full
B	The four database tables
C	Security measures already in place
D	Glossary

Appendix A Environment variables in full

These are the settings pasted into the host's control panel. They are the site's credentials; they are never committed to the code and never visible to a reader.

SETTING	REQUIRED	WHAT IT IS
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL</code>	YES	The live address, <code>https://www.vaaram.ca</code> , with no trailing slash. Used for links in the sitemap and social cards.
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL</code>	YES	The database address.
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY</code> or <code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY</code>	YES	The public key. Safe in a browser — every request it makes is still filtered by the database's own permission rules.
<code>SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY</code> or <code>SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY</code>	YES	The privileged key, used only on the server to write enquiries and subscribers. Never share this.
<code>R2_ACCOUNT_ID</code>	OPTIONAL	The five Cloudflare R2 settings. Present together, all files go to R2 and downloads are free. Absent, everything falls back to Supabase Storage and the site still works — see Part 4.
<code>R2_ACCESS_KEY_ID</code>	OPTIONAL	
<code>R2_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY</code>	OPTIONAL	
<code>R2_BUCKET_NAME</code>	OPTIONAL	
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_R2_PUBLIC_URL</code>	OPTIONAL	
<code>WEB3FORMS_ACCESS_KEY</code>	OPTIONAL	Emails a copy of each enquiry to your inbox. Enquiries are saved either way.

Appendix B The four database tables

TABLE	ONE ROW IS ...	HOLDS
<code>publications</code>	One edition	Title, web address, description, edition type, publication date, file address, file size, page count, cover address, published or draft, view count, download count.
<code>ad_banners</code>	One website banner	Advertiser, link, artwork for up to three device sizes, placement, edition restriction, order, active flag, start and expiry dates, impressions, clicks.
<code>enquiries</code>	One contact form message	Name, email, phone, edition, category, subject, message, source, status.
<code>subscribers</code>	One newsletter reader	Email address (unique, lower case), source, active flag, date they left. Deliberately minimal — no name, no preferences, nothing that would make it a profile.

Four small helper routines also exist in the database, one for each counter — edition views, edition downloads, banner impressions, banner clicks. Each does exactly one thing: add one to a single number, in a way that cannot lose a count when two readers arrive at the same instant.

Appendix C Security measures already in place

MEASURE	WHAT IT PREVENTS
Row Level Security on all four tables	The database itself refuses to hand out an unpublished edition, an enquiry or a subscriber address to the public, regardless of what any page asks for. It is enforced by the database, not by the website's own code.
Admin routes guarded twice	Every <code>/admin</code> address checks for a signed-in session before it renders, and every action re-checks independently — so an action cannot be triggered from outside the dashboard.
Public sign-up disabled	Only addresses invited from the Supabase dashboard can ever obtain an administrator login.
Signed, expiring upload permissions	An upload link is valid for ten minutes and for one specific file. Nobody can use the site to store arbitrary files.
File type and size enforced on the server	Only PDF, JPG, PNG and WebP are accepted, with their own size ceilings, checked before any upload begins.
Advertiser links sanitised	A banner link that is not <code>http</code> or <code>https</code> is discarded — both when it is saved and again when it is displayed.
Content Security Policy	The browser is told exactly which sources may load code, images and fonts. The site cannot be embedded inside another site, plugins are blocked, and forms can only submit back to Vaaram.
HTTPS enforced with HSTS	Browsers are instructed to use an encrypted connection for two years, including on every subdomain.
Rate limits and spam traps	On the contact form, the newsletter box and the counters.
No visitor tracking	No cookies for advertising, no IP logging, no third-party analytics. Only aggregate counters — which is also why no cookie banner is needed.

Appendix D Glossary

TERM	IN PLAIN WORDS
Edition / issue	One week's magazine — one PDF and one page on the site.
Draft	An edition that is uploaded but hidden from readers.
Slug	The readable part of a web address, e.g. <code>2026-09-13-weekly-issue-205</code> .
Placement	One of the ten fixed positions where a website banner can be shown.
Impression	One occasion on which a banner was shown to a reader.
Click rate	Clicks divided by impressions, as a percentage. The number an advertiser asks for.
Egress / bandwidth	Data sent out to readers. See Part 4.
Storage bucket	The place the PDFs and images are kept, separate from the website itself.
DNS	The address book of the internet — what tells a browser which server <code>vaaram.ca</code> means.
Deploy	Publishing a new version of the website's code, as opposed to publishing an edition.
Supabase	The service holding the database and your login.
Cloudflare R2	The file storage service that does not charge for downloads.

Where to go from here

Three things happen next, and only the first needs you.

1 Send back page 5.7

The contact details, the GoDaddy invitation, the mailbox decision and the hosting choice.

2 We set up the accounts and deploy

Roughly one working day, plus waiting time for the domain to take effect.

3 We publish the first edition together

On a call, so you do it rather than watch it. After that the weekly job is five minutes: export, drop, title, publish.

A short note on what was tested for this document

Publishing an edition, editing it, unpublishing and deleting it, creating a banner with three artwork sizes, submitting the contact form and seeing it arrive in the dashboard, signing up to the newsletter, changing an enquiry's status, and reading an edition in the browser reader — all were carried out on the finished software and are shown in the screenshots throughout. Two defects were found in the process and fixed: the PDF reader and cover generator failed on current versions of Chrome and Edge, and both now work (see the note after Figure 2.15). The remaining known inconsistency is the placeholder size label described at the end of section 3.9.